2. Student Voice & District Engagement

Emails, packets, reports and notes from the work with the Board, the superintendent and school leaders, in date order.

Overview: Student Voice & Safety Initiative

STUDENT VOICE & SAFETY INITIATIVE — Amplifying Student Voice Sun Prairie West High School • Sun Prairie Area School District. A Student Safety & Trust Framework • Student Senate • Act 95 & Weighted GPA • District Leadership Engagement • Civic Advocacy. Compiled by Zackary Mark • AVID Scholar • 2025–26 School Year – Present.

Meet the Advocate

Zackary Mark — Student Advocate • AVID Scholar • Sun Prairie West High School "Asking 'Why?' can be the beginning of meaningful change."

- Focus: Public policy, education, government, and civic engagement
- On the ground: Active in SPASD Student Voices, Student Senate, and district safety/trust conversations since January 2026
- Beyond the district: Engages city leadership directly — including public-safety technology oversight with the Sun Prairie Police Department
- Looking ahead: Plans to pursue a double major in Social Studies Education and Political Science

The Journey: A Timeline of Student-Led Advocacy

From a January email to the Board to an ongoing seat at the table with district and city leadership.

- Jan 2026 — Framework Proposed: Proposes a Student Safety & Trust Framework directly to the Board of Education.
- Jan 26, 2026 — Act 95 Public Hearing: Student-led Act 95 group presents survey findings and a recommendation to the Board.
- Feb–Mar 2026 — Student Support Check-Ins: Recurring working sessions with SPWHS administration and district staff begin.
- Apr 2026 — Senate & Interviews: Runs for Student Senate; joins the SPWHS principal interview team.
- May 2026 — New Superintendent: Board selects Dr. Antoine Reed to lead SPASD starting July 1.
- Jul 2026 — Civic Engagement: Meets with Sun Prairie Police Chief Kevin Warych on ALPR camera policy and oversight.

Where It Started: The Student Safety & Trust Framework

Proposed to the Board of Education in January 2026, aligned with DPI guidance on safe, supportive learning environments.

1. Acknowledge & Communicate — Clear communication when serious incidents occur, even when details can't be shared.
2. Safety & Reporting Overview — A districtwide, accessible explanation of how concerns are reported, investigated, and resolved.
3. Consistent Protocols — The same conduct and safety standards applied across every SPASD building.
4. Strengthened Student Voice — Formal, ongoing advisory structures with required administrative response.
5. Proactive Wellness Supports — Advisory time, manageable counselor caseloads, and clear pathways to help.
6. Ongoing Review & Reflection — Regular climate surveys and transparent public reporting on progress.

Project Overview: What the Student Voice Project Does

- Represent — Give every student a seat in conversations that shape their education.
- Gather — Collect honest, districtwide feedback through a bilingual student survey.
- Advocate — Turn feedback into concrete asks, like a weighted GPA policy.
- Connect — Build direct lines between students and district and city leadership.

Student Leadership: Student Senate

Launched by SPWHS Principal Peggy Shoemaker for the 2026–27 school year, seeded directly by the Act 95 & Weighted GPA student groups. "I have been deeply impressed with your voice and agency on Act 95 and weighted grading." — Principal Peggy Shoemaker

1. Two Paths to a Seat — Members join by student-body election (grade-level ballot) or by a fair drawing among Act 95 working-group volunteers.
2. Grade-Level Representation — Nine senators elected in spring 2026, three each from the incoming 10th, 11th, and 12th grade classes.
3. Direct Pipeline — Senate works with administration to set concrete goals and an action plan for 2026–27.
4. Growing the Model — After being passed over for the first Senate cohort, Zackary proposed expanding Student Council's role to include structured feedback — a reminder that advocacy adapts when one door doesn't open.

Data Collection: Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback

A bilingual (English/Español) survey, open to students, families, and staff, built around four focus areas identified in meetings with district leadership. Four focus areas:

- Development of a Student Senate / advisory structure
- Student involvement in leadership decisions (principal & superintendent searches)
- Communication & transparency around safety, policy, and student services

- Trust and consistency across schools

Sample questions:

- "Do you feel students currently have a meaningful voice in district decisions?"
- "How would you rate communication to students about important issues?" (1–5 scale)
- "Should students have a role in leadership decisions, such as principal or superintendent selection?"
- "What specific changes would you like to see moving forward?" (open response)

Policy Context: Why Act 95 Matters to Sun Prairie Students

The law: Wisconsin Act 95 created the Wisconsin Guarantee and Direct Admit Wisconsin, giving guaranteed admission to University of Wisconsin System schools for top-ranked students in every graduating class. "The sole criterion for ranking pupils shall be the pupil's grade point average." — Wisconsin Act 95

- Top 5% — Guaranteed admission to UW–Madison
- Top 10% — Guaranteed admission to all other UW System schools

The problem for Sun Prairie: Class rank runs on GPA alone, and SPASD currently ranks students on an unweighted scale. An unweighted "A" in a study hall counts the same as an "A" in AP Calculus or AP Chemistry. Students who challenge themselves in honors and AP courses can be pushed out of the top 5% and 10% by peers with lighter schedules. 31 SPWHS students, including Zackary, organized as the Act 95 group, gathered student voice, and presented a recommendation at the January 26, 2026 Board hearing.

Our Ask: A Weighted GPA System for SPASD

Give rigor its due weight, so students who take the hardest classes aren't penalized under Act 95 ranking.

- 4.0 — Standard scale today: an A is an A, regardless of course difficulty
- 29 — SPWHS students organized in the Weighted GPA working group, alongside the Act 95 group
- 5%/10% — The Act 95 rank thresholds that decide UW guarantee eligibility

What Student Senate is asking the Board to consider:

1. Add weighted points for Honors, AP, and dual-enrollment coursework on the SPASD transcript scale.
2. Model the change against three graduating classes to confirm it doesn't create new inequities.
3. Use the Student Advocacy survey to bring student and family sentiment directly into the board's discussion.

Building Relationships: Meeting with District & Building Leadership

1. New Superintendent — Dr. Antoine Reed: Building a working relationship with SPASD's incoming superintendent, who took office July 1, 2026.
2. Board Leadership — Diana McFarland, Board President: Ongoing correspondence since January 2026 on the Safety & Trust Framework and student representation.

3. District Administration — Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Director of Secondary Teaching, Learning & Equity: coordinates staff follow-through on student proposals.
4. Building Leadership — Peggy Shoemaker & John Barth, SPWHS Principal and Associate Principal: partners on Student Senate, the survey, and behavior-matrix feedback.

Civic Engagement: Beyond the District, Public Safety Oversight

On July 10, 2026, Zackary met with Sun Prairie Police Chief Kevin Warych to discuss the city's Flock ALPR camera program, applying the same transparency and accountability lens to city government.

1. Purpose & Use — What goals the cameras serve, and how many cases they've directly helped solve.
2. Data & Privacy — What's captured, how long it's retained, and who can access it.
3. Oversight — Audit practices, misuse safeguards, and accountability if policy is violated.
4. Community Trust — How resident feedback, including immigration-related concerns, shapes policy.

Approach: pro-public-safety, not anti-technology — seeking the same transparency for city surveillance tools as for school safety systems.

Moving Forward: Next Steps

1. Field the Student Advocacy & School Climate survey districtwide and report results to the Board
2. Establish a recurring check-in with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed
3. Support Student Senate's first 2026–27 action plan, including the weighted GPA proposal
4. Formalize a Student Advisory Representative role bridging students and administration
5. Follow up on ALPR policy questions with the Sun Prairie Police Department

Emails with the Board, District and School (Jan.–May 2026)

This document compiles a series of emails, meeting notes, and advocacy materials from Sun Prairie West High School student Zackary Mark, documenting his ongoing efforts from early 2026 to strengthen student safety, trust, and voice across the Sun Prairie Area School District (SPASD). Through formal correspondence with the Board of Education, district leadership, school administrators, and staff, Zackary raises concerns about consistency, transparency, and accountability in response to serious incidents, while proposing a Student Safety and Trust Framework aligned with Wisconsin Department of Public Instruction (DPI) guidance.

The record traces how student concerns about school climate, communication after critical events, leadership decisions, and districtwide discipline practices led to concrete next steps, including Student Voices meetings, invitations to advisory roles, the development of a Student Senate, and expanded student participation in principal and superintendent hiring processes. The document also includes the agenda for a student advocacy meeting, a bilingual Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback form, and follow-up communication illustrating collaboration between students and district staff. Overall, it serves as both a case study and a working archive of student-led advocacy aimed at improving safety, transparency, and shared decision-making in SPASD.

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E-001 · Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Jan 13, 2026

Dear Members of the Sun Prairie Area School District Board of Education,

I am writing as a follow-up to prior student concerns regarding school climate, safety, and transparency across the Sun Prairie Area School District. I appreciate the time and attention the Board has given to student and family feedback, and I am writing to further clarify the depth of concern being felt by students and to propose a constructive framework for moving forward.

As students, we recognize that schools operate within complex legal, personnel, and privacy constraints. At the same time, it is important to communicate that the cumulative effect of multiple incidents across the district—at the elementary, middle, and high school levels—has contributed to an atmosphere of uncertainty and concern among students. These concerns are shaped not only by specific publicly reported cases, but also by the perception that some issues are addressed quietly or without clear communication to the broader school community.

Many students have shared that when serious situations arise and little is acknowledged publicly beyond limited statements, it becomes difficult to understand how safety systems are functioning or how future harm is being prevented. This uncertainty affects students' sense of security and their ability to fully engage in learning.

The Wisconsin Department of Public Instruction emphasizes safe, supportive, and inclusive learning environments, as well as continuous improvement through reflection, transparency, and stakeholder engagement. From a student perspective, safety includes not only physical protection, but also trust in reporting systems, confidence in adult accountability, and clarity about how concerns are handled across the district.

In the spirit of constructive problem-solving, I respectfully offer the following Student Safety and Trust Framework for the Board's consideration. This framework is intended to align with DPI guidance while responding to student experiences.

First, clear acknowledgment and communication when serious incidents occur. Even when details cannot be shared, district communication that acknowledges impact, explains general processes, and reaffirms safeguards would help reduce speculation and anxiety among students and families.

Second, a districtwide safety and reporting overview. Students and families would benefit from a clear, accessible explanation of how concerns are reported, investigated, and resolved, including the roles of school administration, district leadership, and external authorities, when applicable. Transparency about process builds trust without violating privacy.

Third, consistent implementation of safety and conduct protocols across all schools. Students notice differences in how similar situations are handled between buildings. A clearly defined, districtwide framework aligned with restorative practices and DPI expectations would promote fairness and accountability.

Fourth, strengthened student voice related to school climate and safety. Establishing formal, ongoing student advisory structures at the middle and high school levels, with required administrative responses, would ensure that student concerns are heard and addressed in a meaningful way.

Fifth, proactive mental health and wellness supports. DPI's whole-child approach emphasizes prevention and early intervention. Regular advisory time, manageable counselor caseloads, and clear pathways for accessing support would help students feel supported before concerns escalate.

Finally, ongoing review and reflection. Regular climate surveys, transparent summary reporting, and public discussion of improvement efforts would demonstrate a commitment to continuous improvement and responsiveness to student and family feedback.

I share these thoughts not to assign blame, but to advocate for systems that help students feel safe, supported, and confident in the adults and structures meant to protect them. SPASD has the opportunity to strengthen trust by addressing not only individual incidents, but also the broader systems that shape student experiences across the district.

Thank you for your continued service and for your willingness to consider student perspectives as part of SPASD's ongoing improvement efforts.

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-002 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Jan 13, 2026

Zackary,

Thank you for such a thoughtful email. Diana will respond on behalf of the board, but as a community member I want to sincerely thank you for sharing your perspectives, concerns and such great ideas for a framework. I admire how you offered solutions while advocating for yourself and other students. Keep up the great work!

Melissa

E-003 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Jan 15, 2026

01/15/2026

Dear Zackary,

Thank you for reaching out to the board and being engaged. I appreciate your efforts to improve our school district by communicating with me and other board members about school safety and transparency. Your continued advocacy is exactly what our community needs!

According to school board policy, the board president will provide you with an official response soon if she hasn't already. But I wanted to respond to let you know that I had received and read your email.

Thank you for your understanding. Isaac Sung

E-004 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Jan 20, 2026

Dear Zachary, Thank you for taking the time to write such a careful and respectful message. First, I want to apologize for the delay in this response. I personally am responsible for speaking on behalf of all seven Board members, and I usually try to do so as quickly as possible. In this case, I did not want to reply until the full Board could come together to discuss a response to your email, and it took longer than I had initially hoped. I also want to acknowledge the thoughtfulness, maturity, and care for your fellow students that are evident throughout your email. It is clear that your intent is not to assign blame, but to contribute constructively to our collaborative efforts to improve our school community for all our students. The concerns you describe are ones the Board hears and takes seriously. You are absolutely right that schools operate within legal, personnel, and privacy constraints, and you are equally right that those constraints can unintentionally contribute to uncertainty when communication feels limited. When the Board crafts a public statement, it must keep in mind the wide breadth of potential readers, and that can make it feel a bit impersonal to the students and educators most closely impacted by the topic at hand. This is part of why we also assign a Board member as a liaison to each school, so we can ensure the Board does not feel too removed from the schools we serve. I am the Board's elected liaison to PPA, and we are also actively recruiting to fill our open Student Board Representative seat for PPA. I visited PPA twice last week, and I plan to visit regularly throughout the rest of the school year as well. I promise you, the Board is paying close attention to the experiences of students and educators in your school community.

There will always be room for us to improve, and in that light I want to directly address some of the issues you are raising:

- This Board agrees with the importance of transparency, and that is why we opted to publicly share the recent report we received from the Board's selected independent investigator with our community. We also established a website (https://www.sunprairieschools.org/district/news/arrest-of-former-spwhs-employee) to provide additional information, and we will continue to update the FAQ portion of that website as needed to address additional questions we receive.
- The Board has recently updated our Concert & Complaint (https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/DFRMCQ5A9EB0/$file/Board%20Procedure%2013%2C%20Formal%20Appeal%20Process.pdf) process, and with the help of our Community Voices we are continuing to work on improvements to that process. This is just one example of many plans we have for continuous improvement based on community feedback. This year was also our first year holding Student Voices meetings for an hour prior to the full Community Voices meetings, and we hope to see more students participate in these meetings in the future as we are able to spread the word about that opportunity to interact with the Board.
- Student safety is incredibly important to us all, and you did a great job acknowledging that this goes far beyond physical safety. You deserve to have teachers and school systems you can trust, understand, and have confidence in over time. The Secondary Behavior Response matrix is in all of our high school handbooks

(https://www.sunprairieschools.org/east-high/sun-prairie-high-school-academics/student-handbook) under Appendix A. You can view it directly HERE (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1iEbCDY6BcJn6Hlp5a0Rz62xh8OJCBFdy/view). A group is working to create an elementary behavior matrix as well. We very much appreciate hearing the perspective of students regarding the effectiveness of implementation moving forward.

- Student-Centered Decision Making and Respect are two of our Core Values (https://www.sunprairieschools.org/district/mission-values), and those values inform the Board's policies such as OE10 - Learning Environment (https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/CQSRUM6C41A4/$file/OE-10%20Learning%20Environment%20(Revised%204-10-23).pdf). This is where the Board names the expectations we have for the District and monitors the District's adherence to those expectations annually in our public Board meetings. Students are welcome to attend and speak at those meetings, as well as email Board members with their concerns at any time.

Thank you again for engaging respectfully and courageously in this work. Student voices like yours are essential to continuous improvement, and your willingness to speak thoughtfully on behalf of your peers does not go unnoticed. I encourage you to continue sharing your perspective and to remain engaged in the conversations ahead. This spring we will be hiring a new Superintendent to lead our District moving forward, and the person we choose to hire will have a deep impact on many of the policy and process issues you indicated interest in. We hope you will engage in our transparent community engagement opportunities as we work to select the best candidate on behalf of our community. On behalf of the Board, thank you for your advocacy and for your commitment to helping make SPASD a place where all students feel safe, supported, and heard. Sincerely,

Diana

E-005 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Jan 22, 2026

Dear President McFarland and Members of the Board,

Thank you for your thoughtful response and for sharing my email with the full Board. I appreciate your attention to student concerns and your explanation of steps being taken to improve transparency, safety, and student voice.

I am encouraged by the following updates:

- The decision to publicly sharI am glad to hear about these updates:'s report and maintain an updated FAQ for the comYou have updated the Concern & Complaint process and are continuing to work with Community Voices. Voices.
- The addition of Student Voices meetings and your hope to increase student participation.
- The focus on student safety is more than just physical security, including trust in systems and accountability.

- The Secondary Behavior Response Matrix and the work underway to create an elementary version.

I would like to stay actively involved as a student partner in this work. In particular, I am interested in:

- Student Voice Structures – Learning more about how students can participate in the Student Voices meetings and how feedback from those meetings will be communicated back to students.
- Implementation of the Behavior Matrix – Providing student feedback on how consistently the Secondary Behavior Response Matrix is being applied in classrooms and across buildings, and how that impacts our sense of fairness and safety.
- Climate and Communication – Exploring ways to ensure that when serious incidents occur, students receive timely, age-appropriate information that both respects privacy and helps us understand how systems are responding.

As you move forward with the superintendent search, I would also welcome any opportunities for students to give input on the qualities and priorities we would like to see in the district's next leader—especially around safety, transparency, and trust.

If it would be helpful, I would be glad to:

- Attend a Student Voices or Community Voices meeting to share student perspectives in person.
- Participate in a small student advisory conversation about school climate and safety.
- Help share information with other students about how to engage with the Board and district processes.

I offer this draft and my ongoing engagement in the spirit of partnership and with deep respect for the Board's role and constraints. I also recognize that any future policy or resolution language may need to be refined by the Board or administration to align with existing policy and legal guidance.

If the Board or administration determines that additional student input or assistance would be helpful during the implementation of safety, transparency, or governance initiatives, I am more than willing to support this work in an appropriate capacity.

Additionally, for the upcoming school year, should there be a vote or selection process for student representatives to the Board or related advisory roles, I would respectfully express my interest in serving and contributing a student perspective to district governance.

Thank you again for your responsiveness, your time, your service to our community, and your openness to student voice. I remain committed to working together so that all students in SPASD feel safe, supported, and heard.

Sincerely,

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-006 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Jan 24, 2026

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for the thoughtful response. I'm glad you hear you want to be actively involved! Please feel free to come to our next Student Voices meeting at 4:30pm March 10th in room 100 of the District Service Center building at 501 S. Bird St. Spread the word and bring your friends? Would you feel comfortable giving feedback on the implementation of the behavior matrix and climate to one of our district administrators? If so, I'd be happy to make a connection for you. The Board can always listen to that feedback, but day-to-day implementation is really in the hands of our educators and I want your feedback to reach the people who are most closely connected to the work so it can have the most impact possible.

Monday night, January 26, the Board will meet beginning at 6pm. The first item on the agenda is a public hearing on Act 95, primarily led by a group of students who helped gather student voice and opinion before developing a recommendation to the Board. Then we will also view presentations by four Superintendent Search firms. If you would like to attend and provide public feedback in person, or watch the video of the meeting at home and then email us your thoughts here, we would love to hear more from you! Once the Board selects a search firm we will start to get community feedback on more of the things you named above such as the qualities and priorities we would like to see in our district's next leader. So if you'd like to wait to attend meetings until we get to that point I completely understand. These meetings can often take quite a bit of time, and you do not need to attend them all to have your voice heard.

If you do enjoy the topics of Board meetings and have the time and interest in being a Student Representative to the Board, we currently have an open seat for a PPA Representative. You can read a bit about how that position works here (https://go.boarddocs.com/wi/spasd/Board.nsf/files/DBVRP26D6486/$file/Board%20Procedure%203%2C%20Student%20Representatives%20to%20the%20School%20Board%20(12-9-24).p df). I have been working with Principal Barrett and a couple other teachers to try to recruit an interested student, so if that is something you would like to learn more about why don't we set up a time to chat in person and I can answer any questions you might have? I know they have been asking around to see who might be interested, so I would need to check back in with them to see if any other students also want to be considered for that role before making any commitments.

I hope you have a wonderful weekend,

Diana

E-007 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Jan 30, 2026

Dear Members of the Sun Prairie Area School District Board of Education,

Thank you again for your responses and for the chances you've given students to share our perspectives, including through Student Voices and feedback on the behavior matrix and school climate. I appreciate that my previous emails have been taken seriously and shared with the full Board.

I'm writing to follow up with more specific and district-wide concerns in light of:

The firing and criminal charges involving former Sun Prairie West High School Principal, Ms. Jen Ploeger; The decision to keep Mr. Barrett in his leadership role at Prairie Phoenix Academy (PPA); and Ongoing incidents and patterns affecting students at Sun Prairie East High School, Sun Prairie West High School, Prairie Phoenix Academy, and at the middle and elementary school levels.

Together, these situations raise important questions about consistency, safety, transparency, and accountability across the entire district.

1\. Firing and Criminal Charges Involving Former SPWHS Principal, Ms. Ploeger

From a student point of view, learning that Ms. Ploeger was fired and is now facing criminal charges has been shocking and confusing. Students at West, East, and PPA have mostly heard about this through rumors and media, not through clear, student-focused communication.

I want to be clear that I personally understand how and why she was criminally charged in connection with child neglect. I recognize the

seriousness of those allegations and why they rise to the level of a criminal case.

However, many students do not understand this. They have not been given any kind of accessible explanation (within legal limits) about what "child neglect" means in this context, what kinds of failures or actions can lead to that charge, and how the district responds when there are serious concerns about student safety.

There is also a broader concern: students are aware of other situations where staff or teachers have allegedly failed to act to protect students or have been involved in what feels like serious neglect of student needs or safety. In those cases:

We have not seen the same level of public acknowledgement; There has often been very little communication with students or families; and There have not been visible consequences or criminal charges.

This creates a perception that some incidents of child neglect or serious harm are treated as criminal and fully addressed, while others seem to be minimized, kept quiet, or handled privately without clear accountability. Even if there are legal reasons for different outcomes, the lack of communication makes it hard for students to understand the difference or trust that all cases are being taken seriously.

I understand that you cannot share every detail of a legal case or a personnel matter. But right now, most students don't understand what happened, what "child neglect" really means in this

situation, or how the district is making sure that similar failures do not happen again in any building.

2\. Retention of Mr. Barrett at Prairie Phoenix Academy

At the same time, students have raised multiple concerns about the leadership and climate at Prairie Phoenix Academy under Mr. Barrett. These concerns include:

Students feeling dismissed or not believed when they report safety issues, bullying, or staff behavior; A sense that staff and administrators are not always held to the same standards and consequences as students; and A feeling that some of the same patterns of ignoring or minimizing student concerns that show up at West and East are also happening at

PPA.

While serious action has been taken in response to issues involving Ms. Ploeger, Mr. Barrett remains in his leadership role and is involved in recruiting a Student Representative to the Board. To many students, this feels inconsistent and confusing:

Why is one principal removed and facing criminal charges, while another administrator with ongoing student complaints remains in place without visible accountability or change? What clear process or criteria does the district use to decide when an administrator is removed, reassigned, or kept in their position?

Again, my goal is not to attack any individual personally. I am questioning the systems, standards, and decision-making processes that apply to people in powerful positions in our schools.

3\. Issues at East, West, PPA, Middle Schools, and Elementary Schools

These concerns are not limited to one school. Across the district, students, families, and staff have reported:

At East, West, and PPA: inconsistent discipline, rules being enforced differently depending on the student, and students feeling unsafe or ignored when they report bullying, harassment, or staff behavior. At middle schools: bullying, discriminatory language, and safety issues where students feel that consequences are inconsistent or that follow-up doesn’t always happen, especially for repeated behavior. At elementary schools: worries from younger students and families about behavior and safety, and about how early harmful patterns are addressed—or not addressed—which shapes whether kids feel safe speaking up as they get older.

This is also personal to me. I have a sibling currently in middle school who has experienced some of these same problems: feeling like concerns aren’t always taken seriously, that bullying or harmful behavior is handled unevenly, and that it’s not always clear which adults they can trust to act. I also know students in other middle and elementary schools who have had similar experiences.

I don’t want my sibling and their classmates to come into high school already feeling like the system won’t protect them or listen to them. My hope is that these issues will be addressed before they get to high school—and ideally much sooner—so that:

Students entering high school next year, and Current high school students at East, West, and PPA

can have more trust that the district will act fairly and protect their safety.

4\. How This Affects Trust and Willingness to Speak Up

When students across the district see:

A principal fired and charged with child neglect, but with almost no student-facing explanation; Other situations that feel like neglect or serious failures to protect students that are not talked about or addressed publicly; and Another administrator kept in place despite ongoing concerns;

it sends some harmful messages:

That only some serious problems get fully addressed and others may be handled quietly or not at all; That adults in similar positions may not be held to the same standards; and That student concerns may not actually lead to investigation or change.

This makes it harder for students to trust the system or to feel safe coming forward. Students—especially younger students, marginalized students, and those in alternative settings like PPA—need to see that:

Their experiences matter and will be taken seriously; There are clear, consistent processes for handling concerns about staff and administrators; and The district will communicate openly, within legal limits, about how these issues are being addressed.

5\. What I’m Asking the Board and District to Do

Because of all of this, I’m respectfully asking the Board and district leadership to consider these specific steps:

Clear, Student-Focused Communication Share written communication with students and families at East, West, PPA, and at middle and elementary schools that:

Explains, in clear and simple language, as much as can be legally and ethically shared about the situation involving Ms. Ploeger and the

meaning of the child neglect charge; Clarifies what the district can and cannot say about personnel and legal matters, so people understand the limits; and Describes what has been learned and what changes are being made across the district as a result.

Transparent Standards for Administrators and Staff At a policy level (without naming individuals), explain how the district:

Receives and investigates complaints about principals, administrators, and other staff when student safety or possible neglect is involved; Decides when an administrator or staff member is removed, reassigned, disciplined, or reported to outside authorities; and Makes sure those standards are applied consistently at East, West, PPA, and at middle and elementary schools.

Review of Leadership and Climate at PPA and Other Sites Conduct a real, focused review of climate, leadership, and safety at PPA and other schools where concerns have been raised, that:

Actively and confidentially collects feedback from students about their experiences with administration and staff; Looks specifically at whether student safety concerns and possible neglect are being handled consistently and taken seriously; and Includes a clear timeline and next steps, with a general summary back to students and families about what will change.

More and Better Spaces for Student Voice In addition to Student Voices, create or expand:

School-based forums at East, West, and PPA where students can talk directly about safety, discipline, leadership, and trust; Age-appropriate ways for middle and elementary students and families to share concerns and get responses; and Clear, well-communicated options (including anonymous ones when needed) to report concerns about staff or administrators.

Include Students With Direct Experience In any committees, working groups, or feedback processes on leadership, climate, safety, or the behavior matrix, make sure to include:

Students from East, West, and PPA; and Student perspectives that reflect middle school experiences and from

students who have gone through alternative schooling, discipline processes, or safety-related incidents.

I am very willing to be involved in this work and to collaborate with students from East, West, PPA, and other schools. I would also be willing to meet directly with the Board—either in person or virtually—if that would help move these conversations and solutions forward.

6\. My Commitment to Ongoing Follow-Up and Board Participation

I want to be clear that I will keep following up on these issues and on your responses until I see real, concrete steps being taken and clearly communicated across the district. This is not a one-time email for me—it's something I plan to stay engaged in.

I will be attending Board meetings, both virtually and in person when I can, to stay informed and to make sure that action is being taken on all of these concerns, not just the ones that have already been publicly addressed. I plan to keep asking questions and raising student experiences from East, West, PPA, and from the middle and elementary levels until students can clearly see that their safety, voices, and rights are being prioritized.

I know these are difficult and sensitive issues, and I appreciate that you are willing to hear from students even when what we say is uncomfortable. My goal is not to undermine the district, but to help it live up to its values and become a model for real student-centered transparency and accountability.

Thank you for your time, for your service to our community, and for your attention to these concerns. I look forward to your response and to any chances to work together on these issues.

E-008 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>, Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 3, 2026

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for your continued advocacy and for taking the time to share such a comprehensive and thoughtful set of concerns with the Board. Your willingness to engage deeply with these issues reflects a strong commitment to your peers and to the district as a whole.

I want to acknowledge the role the Board plays in this work, and also connect you with additional staff within our system that are best positioned to help with the concerns you have raised. As a Board, we care deeply about trust, consistency, safety, and communication. We are actively working to improve Board level communication in ways that build trust with students, families, and the broader community.

The Board's primary responsibilities are governance, policy, and oversight. You have outlined several specific concerns and action steps related to school climate, leadership practices, follow-up on reports, and student-facing processes. District administration and school-based leadership are best positioned to engage in the kind of detailed, action-oriented conversations you are seeking. I have shared your message with our Superintendent and Director of Student Services. I also want to introduce you to Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy, our Director of Secondary Teaching, Learning, and Equity. She has offered to help connect you with other leaders within our system to ensure your ideas and concerns are heard by those who can take next steps at the school and district level.

Please know that the Board values hearing directly from students, and your feedback helps inform our ongoing oversight and discussions with district leadership. I appreciate your engagement and your desire to work collaboratively to improve the experience and safety of students across the district.

Thank you again for reaching out and for your continued involvement.

Sincerely,

Diana

E-009 · Re: Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework for SPASD

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Zackary Mark (school account), Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Danny Miller <dmille@sunprairieschools.org>, Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 4, 2026

Hi Zackary, (and thanks for making this connection, Diana :)),

Thank you again for your thoughtful message and for the leadership you continue to show in speaking up about issues that matter to students. Your ongoing involvement, such as your recent engagement in Act 95 efforts, demonstrates a strong commitment to improving school climate and student experience for you and your peers. That kind of advocacy makes a real difference.

As a next step, I will be sending a separate email that includes you and several key school staff members who are best positioned to dig into the specific concerns and ideas you raised. My goal is to create a direct space for dialogue, collaboration, and clarity around possible next steps. We can also explore setting up a meeting if that would be helpful, so everyone can talk together and ensure your voice is fully heard.

Thank you for the care, courage, and persistence you bring to this work. I look forward to continuing the conversation and supporting meaningful follow-through.

Warmly, Dr. Chaja-Clardy

E-010 · Next Steps and Support

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, Keith Medema <kamedem@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 4, 2026

Hi Zackary,

As promised, I am including members of the SPWHS team who are best able to support you and to talk through the ideas and concerns you shared in your recent email to the Board of Education.

Joining this conversation are your principal, Ms. Shoemaker; Mr. Barth, your Associate Principal; Mr. Medema, your School Counselor; Ms. Vivi, our school's Restorative Practices Coach; and Ms. Mezei, our school's AVID Site Coordinator. Mr. Barth and Mr. Medema both support students whose last names begin with "M." Ms. Vivi supports student leadership and helps create a positive school community through restorative practices. Ms. Mezei leads our AVID program and works closely with students to support their voice, leadership skills, and sense of belonging. Each of them brings experience and care that can help turn your advocacy into meaningful action.

My hope is that this group can be a space for open conversation, shared understanding, and next steps. I would be happy to help organize a meeting so we can all connect, hear your perspective more clearly, and talk together about possible next steps. If the team prefers to organize the meeting and keep me looped in with updates/next steps, that works as well. Ms. Shoemaker, please just let me know.

Thank you again, Zackary, for the leadership and determination you continue to show in working to improve school climate. I appreciate everyone's willingness to take part in this important conversation, and I look forward to working together.

Warmly,

Dr. Chaja-Clardy

E-011 · Student Support Check In @ Wed Fed 25, 2026 1pm-1:30pm (CST)

From	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org> Reply-To: Jordain Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>. Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 5, 2026

Student Support Check In When: Wed Feb 25, 2026 1pm - 1:30pm (CST) Where: Room 1418 Who: Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Vivi Velasquez, John Barth, Peggy Shoemaker

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E-012 · Updated invitation: Student Support Check In @ Mon Mar 2, 2026 1pm - 1:30pm (CST)

From	Jordain Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org> Reply-To: Jordain Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>. Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 19, 2026

Student Support Check In When: Monday Mar 2, 2026 · 1pm – 1:30pm (CST) Where: Room 1418 Who: Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Vivi Velasquez, John Barth, Peggy Shoemaker

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E-013 · Re: Student Support Check In (March 2 meeting)

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>, another student
Cc	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 23, 2026

Hi all,

I would also like to invite another student to this event, as he will be working alongside me on this project. He will help address student concerns and will contribute his own perspective to the issues we will be discussing.

Thank you all once again for your ongoing support and partnership as we continue working to make the Sun Prairie Area School District a better place.

Best, Zackary Mark

E-014 · Re: Student Support Check In (March 2 meeting)

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>, another student Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 23, 2026

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for your continued leadership and for thinking thoughtfully about your advocacy and engagement.

At this stage, we want to be mindful not to get ahead of ourselves. Our first step is to meet with you to fully understand your concerns and goals, and then determine together what next steps, and who else, might be helpful to include.

I appreciate your partnership and look forward to our conversation.

Best, Sarah

E-015 · Re: Student Support Check In (March 2 meeting)

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
Cc	Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>, another student Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>, John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 23, 2026

Thank you for your note and for clarifying logistics. I wanted to confirm that I will only be inviting another student to the March 2 Student Support Check-In. My reasoning is that he has demonstrated prior follow-through, particularly with the Act 95 waiver process, and I trust him to engage responsibly and constructively in this project.

The goal of having him join is to ensure a broader range of student perspectives while keeping the conversation focused and productive. I appreciate your support and guidance as we work to strengthen student safety, communication, and voice across the district.

Thank you, Zackary Mark

E-016 · Background for Meeting on 02/25/2026

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>. John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Feb 8, 2026

Hi Team,

I’m sending along some background info ahead of our meeting on Wednesday, February 25th, from 1:00–1:30 PM in Room 1418, so everyone has a clear understanding of what we’ll be discussing.

The packet includes:

Pages 1–25: Emails and context from previous discussions, giving background on student concerns, district processes, and prior conversations with the Board and administrators.

Pages 26–28: The questions and goals I’d like us to work through together during the meeting. These focus on student safety, districtwide consistency, leadership transitions, communication, and ways to strengthen student voice.

I’m hoping this gives everyone a clear picture before we meet so we can have a focused, student-led discussion and leave with actionable next steps.

I’m looking forward to hearing your thoughts and collaborating on solutions that make a real difference for students across the district.

(Attachment: background packet — link removed)

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-017 · Email with Board of Education

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Feb 5, 2026

Hi Ms. Vivi,

I wanted to follow up on our recent conversation and share the email chain below in case you would like more context or additional information about the concerns and ideas I raised.

If you have any questions or would like me to clarify anything further, I would be happy to do so. Thank you again.

(Attachment: background packet — link removed)

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-018 · Re: Email with Board of Education

From Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Feb 9, 2026

Thank you Zack!!! For the Feb 25th meeting, do you want me to be there? Do you feel the appropriate people are there?

I appreciate you reaching out and sending me the email chain, and for meeting with me to discuss your concerns. -- Vivi Velasquez

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E-019 · Email with Board of Education

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Feb 9, 2026

Hi Ms. Vivi,

Yes, I would really appreciate it if you could be at the Feb 25th meeting. I feel better having you there and think your perspective would be really helpful.

I'm glad SPWHS admin and a district-level person are involved, but since my concerns are district-wide, I think it would also be helpful to include additional district administration and administration from SP East, so the conversation reflects more than just one school.

Thank you again for your support.

E-020 · Email with Board of Education

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Feb 9, 2026

Hi Ms. Vivi,

I went ahead and shared a Google Doc with you that includes the email chain, my notes, and some additional context that might be helpful for the February 25th meeting. There’s no need to respond to the document. I just wanted you to have everything in one place.

Thank you again for all your support.

SPASD Engagement Notes (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1UEgGUYcWyuxK8kuvOsrlG-2Vyy1abP3JOgLdbDYMGpU/edit?usp=sharing)

SPASD Engagement Emails & Meeting Notes (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tYbQZwF46d7Dkd8DfilYwIWMrpUPAynvJlEsvl3j1BQ/edit?usp=sharing)

E-021 · Re: Email with Board of Education

From Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Feb 9, 2026

Got it! Received :)

E-022 · Follow up from today’s meeting

From Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>

To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Mar 2, 2026

Hi Zack,

Thank you for a productive meeting today. It was a pleasure to meet you. As discussed, here are the next steps we’ll be moving forward with:

1\. You expressed interest in serving on the SPWHS principal interview team. The

interview date options are April 3 and April 7, and I’ve added your name to the list of interested students for either date. 2. Mr. Barth will follow up with Ms. Shoemaker regarding Student Senate and the

possibility of including Act 59/Weighted Grading groups as potential representatives. 3. Mr. Barth will connect with the student services team to gather and share information

for students related to mandated reporting, including when state agencies are involved and when parents are notified in certain situations.

I’ve set a reminder for myself to follow up on these items in two weeks. I know you’ll be out of the country at that time, but I’ll circle back to keep you in the loop.

Thanks again for your leadership and engagement!

Best, Sarah

E-023 · Re: Follow up from today’s meeting

From Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>

To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Mar 16, 2026

Hi everyone,

I hope you’re all doing well. I wanted to check in to see if there have been any updates on the items we discussed at our last meeting.

In particular, I’m wondering if there has been any follow-up regarding the Student Senate development, as well as the information being gathered for students related to mandated reporting.

No rush if things are still in progress; I just wanted to touch base and keep the communication moving.

Thanks again for the time and thought everyone has been putting into this work.

Kind regards, and happy snow day, Sarah

E-024 · Re: Follow up from today’s meeting

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>

To Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>

Cc Zackary Mark (school account), John Barth <jebarth@sunprairieschools.org>, Vivi Velasquez <vmvelas@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Mar 16, 2026

Hello, I am working out the details for the Student Senate. Thanks!

Peg

E-025 · Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	District administration
Cc	Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Apr 15, 2026

Dear district administration,

I am writing to request clarification regarding concerns that arose in 2024 involving former Cardinal Heights and Sun Prairie West High School staff member, Jill Hansen.

In reviewing publicly available information, I was unable to find clear documentation regarding whether an investigation took place or the circumstances surrounding Ms. Hansen’s departure. Based on available information, she continues to hold a valid teaching license and is currently employed in another school district.

I am not making accusations, but I am seeking clarity. Specifically, I would like to better understand:

- What processes the district follows when allegations of this nature arise
- Whether those processes were followed in this situation in 2024 (to the extent that can be shared)
- How the district ensures continuity and accountability in handling serious concerns, particularly during leadership transitions

I appreciate that there may be limitations on what can be shared regarding personnel matters. However, transparency around process and student safety is important for maintaining trust.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

E-026 · Re: Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>, Christopher Sadler <cjsadle@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Apr 15, 2026

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for reaching out and for sharing your questions. I appreciate your continued interest in understanding our district’s processes and commitment to student safety.

Because your inquiry relates to personnel matters and occurred before Mrs. Shoemaker was with us, I am including our Human Resources Director, Dr. Sadler, in this message so he can respond

and address your questions to the extent possible.

Kind regards,

Sarah

E-027 · Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Christopher Sadler <cjsadle@sunprairieschools.org>
Cc	Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Bryn Horton <bmhorto@sunprairieschools.org>, Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>, Colleen Uhlenkamp <cmuhlen@sunprairieschools.org>, Amanda Davis <andavis@sunprairieschools.org>, Melissa Grayson <mjgrays@sunprairieschools.org>, Isaac Sung <cisung@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Apr 27, 2026

Dear Dr. Sadler,

I hope you are doing well. I wanted to follow up on my previous email regarding my inquiry into the district's processes for handling allegations of this nature. I understand these matters can take time, but I wanted to check in to see if there are any updates or if additional time is needed.

I appreciate your attention to this and look forward to your response.

E-028 · Re: Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Diana Mcfarland <dmmcfar@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Date	Apr 28, 2026

Hi Zackary,

I just wanted to reach out once again to thank you for your engagement and to apologize for the delay in receiving a response. Unfortunately, I do not personally have any additional information to offer you, as that will need to come from the administration. However, I want to let you know that I am also keeping an eye on this thread and will be interested to learn more with you when the reply from administration comes through.

All the best, Diana

E-029 · Re: Inquiry Regarding 2024 Concerns and District Process

From	Nicholas Reichhoff <nfreich@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Bradford Saron <bgsaron@sunprairieschools.org>, Stephanie Leonard-Witte <smleona@sunprairieschools.org>, Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>, Sarah Chaja-Clardy <srchaja@sunprairieschools.org>, Christopher Sadler <cjsadle@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	May 5, 2026

Hello Zachary -

Thank you for your patience about your inquiry. It took a bit to get this routed to me, and then it took a bit more time to be able to compose a response. I believe I am best positioned to answer your questions.

As you may have seen from media coverage of this incident, the allegations you referenced arose in 2024 and triggered an investigation that included a Title IX review. Without discussing specific situations about other students with you, I can assure you that a significant number of student interviews were completed, and the families of any students who were identified as potential victims were involved. In addition, school administrators contacted the Sun Prairie Police Department. Based on that information, it was determined that district policies were violated, which resulted in disciplinary action of the staff member. The PD, the Department of Public Instruction, and the school districts involved are all aware of the incident. Decisions related to an individual's teaching license or employment in another district are out of our hands.

Moving forward, the district is committed to following our established protocols to investigate allegations in partnership with the Sun Prairie Police Department. We continue to engage in regular training of leaders so they understand their responsibilities to look into concerns and follow the established procedures to do so thoroughly.

I hope you have a great end to the school year!

Sincerely, Nick

E-030 · Associate Principal Update

From	Sun Prairie East High School <DoNotReply@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Date	Apr 28, 2026

Dear Sun Prairie East Cardinals,

I wanted to take a moment to update everyone on our associate principal staffing. As of Monday, Ms. Looper has resigned her position with the Sun Prairie Area School District for personal reasons. I would like to thank Ms. Looper for her leadership these past two years, and I wish her the best in her future endeavors.

For the remainder of the school year, Allison Fuelling will continue to serve as interim associate principal and cover Ms. Looper's former duties and responsibilities. I plan to post the AP position as soon as possible and aim to fill it this spring. I will be working with school district leadership as well as our in-building leadership teams to organize and plan interviews.

Please reach out to me directly if you have any questions.

Thank you.

Jim Ertel

Principal, Sun Prairie East High School

E-031 · Associate Principal Recommendation

From Sun Prairie East High School <DoNotReply@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date May 21, 2026

Dear Sun Prairie East High School Students, Parents, Caregivers, and Staff,

We are writing to share some exciting news regarding our school's leadership. We are pleased to announce that Allison Fuelling has been recommended as the next associate principal of Sun Prairie East High School! This recommendation will be forwarded to the School Board for consideration on May 26, 2026.

Most recently, Allison has been serving as the Interim Associate Principal at Sun Prairie East. She holds a Bachelor’s degree in Biology and Psychology from Cornell College, Secondary Science Teaching Certification from UW-Madison, and two Master’s degrees: one in Molecular and Cellular Pharmacology from UW-Madison and one in Educational Leadership from Viterbo University. You can view her resume here (https://drive.google.com/file/d/11C8r8o5bZaCcUbmrbTEUkUBZOOA2HS6a/view?usp=sharing) for more information on her professional background.

Allison comes to us with experience in education as an Instructional Coach at Sun Prairie East High School and a Middle School Summer School Principal. Before her service to Sun Prairie, she was a Science Teacher, K-12 Science Specialist, and 7-12 Instructional Coach at Marshall School District. In 2017, she was named Wisconsin Outstanding Biology Teacher of the Year by the National Association of Biology Teachers. Allison also currently serves on the Marshall School Board.

Outside of school, Allison enjoys spending time with her family, gardening, and spending time with friends. Thank you to the students, parents, caregivers, and staff members who participated so thoughtfully in this interview process. Please join us in welcoming Associate Principal Allison Fuelling to our school community! Allison will continue in her current role as interim Associate Principal and will officially begin full-time when her contract takes effect on July 1, 2026.

Sincerely,

Jim Ertel, Principal

E-032 · Request to Continue Student Leadership Work

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Apr 29, 2026

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

I hope you’re doing well.

I wanted to thank you for the opportunity to be part of the Student Senate process. I appreciate the time and effort that went into organizing it, and I’m glad to see strong student interest in leadership at SPWHS.

While I was not selected, I remain committed to strengthening student voice and continuing the work I've already been involved in with both school and district leadership. Over the past several months, I've focused on improving communication, building trust between students and staff, and helping elevate student perspectives.

I would like to formally request a defined role working alongside administration, such as a Student Advisory Representative or student liaison position. My goal is to continue contributing in a structured and consistent way, particularly in areas related to student voice, communication systems, and school climate.

I believe creating or expanding a role like this would not only allow me to stay actively involved, but also help strengthen the connection between students and administration moving forward.

I would appreciate the opportunity to discuss how I can continue contributing in this capacity.

Thank you again for your time and leadership.

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-033 · Re: Request to Continue Student Leadership Work

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Apr 29, 2026

Hello Zach, I will have to think about this. To be honest, what you are asking for is unrealistic. Student Senate will provide me with the student lens to issues we have in our school addressing student voice, communication systems and school climate. Perhaps you may have more voice in another committee in the school or Student Council? I would also encourage you to run again next year.

Warm regards,

Ms. Shoemaker

E-034 · Re: Request to Continue Student Leadership Work

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Apr 29, 2026

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for your response — I appreciate your perspective.

I understand the role Student Senate plays in representing student voice, and I am open to getting involved in Student Council or another committee as you suggested. While I know Student Council often focuses on school events, I would be interested in helping expand its impact by incorporating more structured student feedback and communication with administration.

My goal is to contribute in a way that supports both student engagement and meaningful input on school climate, communication, and student experience.

I would appreciate the opportunity to be involved and continue supporting this work in whatever way is most helpful.

Thank you again for your time.

-- Zackary Mark AVID Scholar Sun Prairie West High School (608) 940 7356 school account

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E-035 · Student Senate

From Sun Prairie West High School <DoNotReply@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Date Apr 13, 2026

Dear Students!

Here is more information about Student Senate!!

- Be a Voice for Your Peers: Actively listen to the ideas, concerns, and needs of the student body and represent those perspectives during Senate meetings.
- Identify Areas of Concern: Openly and constructively discuss challenges facing our school environment, academics, or student life.
- Build Community: Collaborate on new ideas, events, and initiatives that promote inclusivity, school spirit, and a positive campus culture.
- Develop an Action Plan: Work alongside Ms. Shoemaker to establish concrete goals and a strategic action plan for the upcoming 2026-2027 school year.

Student Senate will be made up of three 9th, 10th and 11th graders as well as members of some of our clubs. We will meet weekly next year to discuss problems in our school and how to solve them. If you are interested in being part of this team, please fill out this form

Forms are due Wednesday, April 22. Elections will be held Monday, April 27, 2026. Sign up here: Student Senate Interest Form (https://docs.google.com/forms/d/10GjHclvvHKhtrAI9jvS6DkP9d0jaRp_IzdMhqOvKm00/edit).

Ms. Shoemaker

Principal

Student Senate Interest Form Please fill out the form below by Wednesday, April 22. Elections are Monday, April 27

Name (Short Response)

What is your grade level next year

- I will be in 10th Grade
- I will be in 11th Graade
- I will be in 12th Grade

Why are you interested in representing your grade level as a Student Senator? (Short Response)

Your name will be on the voting ballot. Is there anything else you want students to know about you? (Short Response)

E-036 · STUDENT SENATE

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 18, 2026

Hi Zach,

Thank you for your interest. There are two ways for your to apply to Senate:

1\. I will draw a name from those interested and who are a part of the ACT 95 student group.

2\. You may choose to be included on the grade level ballot for the student body voting at the end of April - first week of May.

Zach, you can certainly choose one or both options. If you are wanting to be a part of the student body voting process, please fill out the interest form asap!

Thanks. Ms. Shoemaker

E-037 · Re: STUDENT SENATE

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Apr 18, 2026

Hi Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the clarification.

I've already submitted the interest form to be included on the student body ballot, and I would also like to be considered through the ACT 95 group selection.

I appreciate the opportunity and look forward to being involved in either process.

Thank you, Zackary

E-038 · Re: STUDENT SENATE

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 18, 2026

Sounds good. Thanks.

E-039 · Student Senate Invite

From Jordan Blank <jnblank@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account) and other students from the Act 95 / weighted grading groups
Date Apr 16, 2026

Dear students,

I have been deeply impressed with your voice and agency leveraged on the ACT 95 and

weighted grading potential policies. I am inviting one of your members to be a part of the

Student Senate. Please reach out to me at pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org if you are interested. In order to be fair, I will draw a name from those interested in serving next year.

With appreciation,

Ms Shoemaker

E-040 · Student Senate Application

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To (undisclosed recipients)
Bcc Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 20, 2026

Hello, Your application has been received! Thank you so much for your interest in Student Senate and in making our school a better place. I want to inform you of next steps:

1\. The vote will be next Monday, April 27 during SP30. 2. On the ballot, your name and why you want to be a part of the Senate will be included. 3. Some of you have asked about posters. You may hang posters anywhere in the Commons with blue tape. The school will not be able to provide you with copies. 4. If for some reason you have decided to not be a part of the election, please let me know soon so I can take your name off of the ballot.

Thank you so much! Have a great day! Ms. Shoemaker

E-041 · Student Senate 1 ([grade level] Ballot)

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026

Dear [grade level] students!

Please find the candidates for the [grade level] Student Senate. I urge you to read through the candidates first before casting your vote. YOU MAY ONLY VOTE FOR ONE and ONLY ONE TIME. I am collecting email addresses so I will know if you voted more than one time. The polls will close at 4:00 pm today.

Who best represents your goals for our school? Vote here: [grade level] (https://)

Thank you!

Ms. Shoemaker

E-042 · Student Senate - New Ballot

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026

Dear [grade level] students,

Here is the new NEW Student Senate Ballot - [grade level] (https://) containing all of the students who wish to be on the ballot and were left off the first time. There was a technical error on my end and it is remedied now.

Reminder: Vote 1 time

Polls close at 4:00 pm on Tuesday

Thank you.

Ms. Shoemaker

E-043 · New Student Senate Ballot

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To (undisclosed recipients)
Bcc Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026

Hello, I wanted to let you know that 4 current students in that grade were left off the ballot due to technical difficulties. I have now included them in the new ballot which will be sent to students today. I wanted to let you know in advance.

Thank you! Ms. Shoemaker

E-044 · Re: New Student Senate Ballot

From Zackary Mark (school account)
To Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
Date Apr 27, 2026

Hi Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the update and for sending out the new ballot.

Do you know when the results of the election will be available, or when they'll be shared with students?

Thank you,

Zackary Mark

E-045 · Re: New Student Senate Ballot

From Peggy Shoemaker <pjshoem@sunprairieschools.org>
To Zackary Mark (school account)
Date Apr 27, 2026

Hi Zackary, Thanks for reaching out. I extended the deadline for [grade level] students we I can announce on Wednesday morning. Thank you!

E-046 · Student Senate Update

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Grade-level student mailing list
Date Apr 29, 2026

Dear [grade level] students,

Three students were elected to Student Senate, serving next year as Seniors.

-
-
-

All students who were running received votes from classmates. Thank you to everyone who was interested in serving. I was very much impressed with your passion for leadership and serving Sun Prairie West.

Ms. Shoemaker

E-047 · Student Senate Update

From Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To Grade-level student mailing list
Date Apr 29, 2026

Dear Tenth Graders,

Three students were elected to Student Senate, serving next year as 11th graders.

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-
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All students who were running received votes from classmates. Thank you to everyone who was interested in serving. I was very much impressed with your passion for leadership and serving Sun Prairie West. Each spring we will conduct another election!

Ms. Shoemaker

E-048 · Student Senate Update

From	Sun Prairie West High School <donotreply@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Grade-level student mailing list
Date	Apr 29, 2026

Dear Ninth Graders,

Three students were elected to Student Senate, serving next year as 10th graders.

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-
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All students who were running received votes from classmates. Thank you to everyone who was interested in serving. I was very much impressed with your passion for leadership and serving Sun Prairie West. Each spring we will conduct another election!

Ms. Shoemaker

March 2, 2026 Student Advocacy Meeting — Agenda, Notes & Next Steps

Sun Prairie Area School District Student Advocacy Meeting – Agenda & Questions

Date: March 2, 2026 Time: 1:00–1:30 PM Location: Room 1418

Purpose: To discuss districtwide student safety, trust, and school climate, and explore actionable next steps with administration. This conversation will include perspectives from students across all SPASD schools and connect to ongoing leadership searches (Superintendent and SPWHS Principal) and community engagement efforts.

Agenda & Key Questions

1\. Safety Communication (0–8 min)

- How is student communication decided after serious incidents?
- Is there a consistent district process or timeline for communicating with students?

2\. Accountability & Consistency (8–15 min)

- How are complaints about staff or administrators reviewed?
- How does the district ensure consistent follow-through across schools?

3\. Leadership Transitions & Community Engagement (15–20 min)

- With the superintendent and SPWHS principal searches underway, how are student perspectives being incorporated?
- How can community engagement strengthen trust during these leadership transitions?

4\. Student Voice & Feedback (20–25 min)

- How will feedback from this conversation lead to concrete action?
- What ongoing structure ensures continued collaboration with students across all schools?

5\. Concrete Next Steps & Follow-Up (25–28 min)

- Which of the proposed initiatives feels most realistic to begin, and what would the timeline look like?
  - (Examples: districtwide student climate listening sessions, student-facing safety communication protocols, ongoing student advisory group, input opportunities for students in leadership searches)

6\. Closing & Confirm Follow-Up (28–30 min)

- Confirm agreed-upon next steps
- Identify responsible parties and timelines
- Confirm how students will be updated on progress

Notes:

This meeting is intended to be solution-focused and collaborative. The goal is to leave with one or two clear action items and a plan for follow-up

Look at the Student Code of Conduct Board of Education - Coach Rob Incident Students are emailed, as well as parents K-8 is not emailed District leadership goes through with complaints What actually happens then to laws/policies Training after incidents Consequences vary with incidents An attorney is always hired Surveys sent out Interview questions were taken with them Student voice with direct spw principal Superintendent firm HYA 3/9 Board of Education meeting Trust? Student services clarity Newsletter issues SP100 - June/November/March - Key district personnel - used to be student senate involved Goals every 100 days Spw principal - Search end April - Start date July 1st Superintendent - Search end April - Start date July 1st Interim principal/superintendent next year?

Next Steps:

You expressed interest in serving on the SPWHS principal interview team. Sarah Chaja-Clardy The interview date options are April 3 and April 7, and I’ve added your name to the list of interested students for either date.

will follow up with regarding Student Senate and the possibility John Barth Peggy Shoemaker of including Act 95/Weighted Grading groups as potential representatives.

will connect with the student services team to gather and share information for John Barth students related to mandated reporting, including when state agencies are involved and when parents are notified in certain situations.

March 2 Meeting Script — Student Partnership & Engagement (word-for-word)

Student Partnership & Engagement Meeting Script – Word-for-Word Purpose: Shift from concern-sharing to system-building. Goal: define scope + secure one structural next step.

0:00–2:00 — Opening & Scope Clarification

“Thank you for meeting today. I appreciate the time and willingness to sit down with students directly.

I want to clarify the purpose of this conversation from the beginning. While student concerns are part of this discussion, my broader goal is long-term structure.

I’m hoping we can focus not only on what students are experiencing, but on how student voice is built into systems moving forward.

This is about sustainability, not a one-time conversation. ”

2:00–7:00 — Framing the Core Themes

“I’ve organized what students are experiencing into three structural categories.

First: Communication Infrastructure.

- Students often receive limited clarity after major events.
- The issue isn’t just information — it’s predictability and process.

Second: Consistency Across Schools.

- Students notice differences in enforcement, follow-up, and tone depending on the building.
- That creates perception gaps in fairness and trust.

Third: Ongoing Student Integration.

- There are opportunities for input, but they aren’t always structured or visible.
- Students want clarity on how feedback moves from conversation to action.

These themes are less about isolated complaints and more about how systems are designed. ”

7:00–17:00 — Strategic Questions (Slow Pace, Take Notes)

A. On Scope

- “How does the district currently define ‘student voice’ in decision-making?”
- “Is there a written or consistent structure that ensures student perspectives influence outcomes?”

B. On Communication Systems

- “What determines the timing and depth of student-facing communication after serious incidents?”
- “Is there an opportunity to create a predictable communication framework students can rely on?”

C. On Leadership & Trust

- “In leadership transitions, what formal role do students play beyond feedback surveys?”
- “What would it take to institutionalize student partnership during these processes?”

Maintain steady posture. No rapid-fire questions. Let silence work for you.

17:00–25:00 — Propose Structural Direction

“I’d like to move toward one concrete structural next step.

Rather than a one-time listening session, I’m proposing one of the following:

- A formal districtwide student advisory framework with a defined meeting cadence.
- A transparent student-facing communication protocol draft.

- A clear integration plan for student input during leadership transitions.

Which of these is most realistic to pilot in the near term?

And what would the timeline look like?”

Let them talk. Write everything down.

25:00–29:00 — Lock Structure

“To ensure this conversation translates into action, I’d like to clarify four things before we close.

- What is the agreed next step?
- Who is responsible for moving it forward?
- What is the timeline?
- How will students receive updates?

Could we summarize those together?”

29:00–30:00 — Close with Stability

“Thank you for engaging in this conversation. Students are committed to partnership and long-term trust-building. We look forward to continuing this work in a structured and collaborative way.”

More Emails: Superintendent Session & Student Update (March–April 2026)

E-049 · Invitation: ACT 95 Group – Superintendent Session @ Mon Apr 13, 2026 13:00–15:10 (CDT)

From Jordain Blank (organizer), Sun Prairie Area School District

To Zackary Mark (school account) and the high school students in the Act 95 group

Date Mar 30, 2026

This is for high school students to participate in the Day in the District on Monday, April 13. This will be your opportunity to meet the superintendent finalists, learn more about each of them, ask questions and offer feedback. The sessions start at 1 p.m. and end around 3:10 p.m.

When: Monday, April 13, 2026, 1:00–3:10 PM (Central) Location: Small Theater

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E-050 · Student Advocacy Update

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To another SPWHS student

Date Apr 3, 2026

Hey [name withheld],

Thanks again for being willing to help out. I really appreciate it.

I wanted to follow up and provide you with a brief update on our current progress. I'll keep it brief here, but I'm happy to share more details if you'd like.

Here are a few key things that are happening right now:

Student Senate: Ms. Peggy Shoemaker and Mr. John Barth are working on establishing the Student Senate so we can have a more consistent space for student voice and feedback.

Community survey: I'm putting together a survey to share with the public. The goal is both to help people better understand what I'm working toward and to give me a clearer picture of what students, families, and community members are most concerned about.

Public report: I recently shared a public report-out, and I'm planning to keep doing that every month. That way, people can see what's been worked on, what's changed, and how my goals are evolving based on what we're hearing.

Leadership and principal support: With Ms. Peggy Shoemaker staying on as Interim SPWHS Principal next year, we'll have more consistent principal support behind this work going into next school year.

District and board leadership: With the upcoming SPWHS ACT 95 Group Superintendent Session to meet candidates for SPASD Superintendent, and the upcoming SPASD Board of Education elections, I'll also be paying close attention to which candidates in both races seem most focused on supporting and positively impacting students.

Staying updated: For anyone who wants to follow this work more closely, updates and public reports will also be shared on social media, through the various Sun Prairie community groups on Facebook and on Instagram at @spasdstudentvoice.

If you have any thoughts, questions, or ideas about any of this, especially around how to make Student Senate or the survey more meaningful for students, I'd really like to hear them.

Thanks again for all your support. I'll keep you updated as things move forward.

Zackary Mark AVID Scholar, Sun Prairie West High School +1 (608) 940-7356 | school account

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E-051 · Re: Student Advocacy Update

From another SPWHS student

To Zackary Mark

Date Apr 4, 2026

Lemme know if you need any help with any of this, or just someone to plug for support. Appreciate all the work you're doing my man!

E-052 · Re: Student Senate Timeline and Next Steps

From Associate Principal John Barth

To Zackary Mark

Date Mar 17, 2026, 8:26 AM

Hey, Zackary,

Thank you for your patience. It's been a crazy couple of weeks with ACT testing and scheduling for next year. I know Ms. Schoemaker is working on the details of the Student Senate. I would look for more details after Spring Break. Thanks!

-Mr. Barth

> Zackary's question (Mar 4): "I wanted to check in about the timeline for when Student Senate can be expected to be up and running. Do you have a rough idea of when things might get started? I'm also wondering if there is anything I can help with or work on now to make sure it can get started as soon as possible."

March 2 Meeting Handout

Meeting 1 Print Out — STUDENT SAFETY & TRUST | MARCH 2 MEETING Prepared by: Zackary Mark, Sun Prairie West HS

Purpose

- Share student concerns and themes
- Guide a solution-focused, collaborative discussion
- Outline next steps and follow-up plan

Meeting Flow

1. Opening (0–2 min) — Appreciation, collaborative framing, focus areas: safety, communication, accountability, student voice
2. Student Concern Themes (2–8 min) — Safety gaps, inconsistent accountability, limited student voice
3. Clarifying Dialogue (8–18 min) — Questions on communication, accountability, leadership engagement, student input
4. Next Step Decision (18–26 min) — Options: student listening session, climate survey, advisory structure, leadership input; define responsible lead & timeline
5. Confirm Follow-Through (26–29 min) — Confirm action, lead, timeline, communication method
6. Closing (29–30 min) — Appreciation, reaffirm goal of safe, student-centered schools

Student Feedback Highlights

- Mixed feelings of safety vs. trust
- Desire for clearer communication
- Concern about fairness/consistency

Example quote: "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen… people be pulling up with knives."

Work Done

Outreach & feedback; draft survey & reports; communication with leadership & Board; teacher/admin engagement.

Current Focus

Consolidate feedback; clarify themes; collaborate on one concrete next step.

Request

Agree on one actionable step; assign lead; set timeline; communicate with students.

Goal: Move from concern → collaboration → action → ongoing partnership. Principle: Students are seeking safety, clarity, fairness, voice, trust — not blame.

Meeting 2 Print Out: (page left blank in the original)

Superintendent Candidates (April 13)

4/13 Superintendent Candidate Meeting — Zack's evaluation notes and question list.

Candidate: Jeff Fleig

1. Learning & Academics — Key ideas: asking students first; staff first; communication on curriculum; academic gaps; shifts every couple of years; 4-year planning as a freshman; changes in administration; temporary staff. Good for student learning? Strong.
2. Student Voice & Involvement — Would they actually listen? Probably.
3. Safety, Mental Health, and Culture — Support for students is mandatory; professionals; keeping kids safe mentally/psychologically in previous city.
4. Opportunities & Fairness — Fair to students across schools? Somewhat.
5. Additional — "Turn around leader." 5 of 14 schools exceeded expectations at the start; ended with 13 of 14 schools exceeding. 31 years in education. Safety; great education; trust and relationships; elementary school expectations.
6. First-year promise heard: Build systems that are going to outlast them.

Overall rating: Not a good fit — too numbers focused; didn't answer questions directly; less informed about the district; team administration; left on bad terms.

Candidate: Antoine Reed

1. Learning & Academics — Good for student learning? Strong.
2. Student Voice & Involvement — No specific groups came to events, losing trust; representation; going to where people are; open hours; student leadership/influencers; communication through a multitude of channels. Would they actually listen? Probably.
3. Safety, Mental Health, and Culture — Teacher help.
4. Opportunities & Fairness — Fair to students across schools? Yes.
5. Additional — Staff support: time, tools, training; keeping key staff.

Overall rating: Pretty strong — energetic; excited to be here; actually wants it; eager to help staff and students mentally.

Candidate: Michael Harris

1. Learning & Academics — Agendas; resources needed; priorities key; community holding administration accountable; same types of education to thrive. Good for student learning? Okay.
2. Student Voice & Involvement — Key on student voices; Student Council of the Superintendent (Milwaukee); visiting schools is key. Would they actually listen? Probably.
3. Safety, Mental Health, and Culture — Student voice for improvement.
4. Opportunities & Fairness — Communication; audit of schools for gaps. Fair across schools? Somewhat.
5. Additional — Listen, learn, improvement. Described as fair, resourceful, and straightforward.
6. First-year promise heard: Quick wins; momentum; no long-term goal.

Overall rating: Unsure/mixed — looking at data most of all; superintendent license in May.

Student Questions for Candidates

A. Students & Learning

1. Improving day-to-day learning: "What are the most important changes you think our schools need to make to improve students' day-to-day learning?"
2. Support for different learners: "How will you support students with different needs and strengths — like advanced learners, students who need extra help, English learners, and students with IEPs?"
3. Preparing us for the future: "How will you make sure students are ready for life after graduation, college, trades, careers, or whatever path we choose?"

B. Student Voice & Involvement

4. Listening to students: "How will you regularly listen to students and make sure our ideas and concerns are part of important decisions?"
5. Hearing from many types of students: "How will you make sure you're hearing from students at different schools, grade levels, and backgrounds, not just the same small group?"

C. Safety, Well-Being, and School Culture

6. Mental health and well-being: "What will you do to improve student mental health support and reduce stress, anxiety, and burnout?"
7. Belonging and respect: "How will you help create school environments where students of all backgrounds feel safe, respected, and like they belong?"
8. Handling problems and discipline: "How do you think schools should handle behavior problems or conflicts so that students are held accountable but also able to learn and grow from mistakes?"

D. Activities, Opportunities, and Equity

9. Clubs, activities, and opportunities: "How will you support more opportunities for students, like clubs, arts, sports, and career/tech programs, especially for students who can't always participate now?"
10. Fairness between schools: "If some schools in the district have more opportunities or better resources than others, how will you address that?"

E. Leadership Style & First-Year Actions

11. How you lead: "How would you describe your leadership style when working with students, staff, and families?"
12. First-year promise: "What is one specific thing you promise to do in your first year that students will actually notice and feel?"

Notes, Outreach & Meeting Scripts

Teacher Responses

On 02/10/2026 Zackary sent the same outreach email to Lisa Mezei, Jennifer Dorner, Natalie Fowler, and Caryn Peters:

> Dear [teacher], I hope you are doing well. I am currently working on a student-led project in collaboration with district and school leadership focused on strengthening student safety, improving communication, and ensuring that student voice is meaningfully included in school decision-making.
>
> As part of this effort, I am gathering brief perspectives from both students and staff to better understand what is working well and where improvements may be needed. Your insight would be greatly appreciated. If you are willing, I would value your thoughts on a few short questions:
>
> - From your perspective, do most students feel safe at school?
>
> - If a serious concern occurred, do students generally feel comfortable reporting it to an adult?
>
> - Do you feel that student concerns are consistently heard and followed up on?
>
> - What is one change that could most improve student safety, trust, or communication in our schools?
>
> Responses can be as brief as you prefer, and participation is completely optional. My goal is simply to ensure this work reflects a range of real experiences and perspectives across our school community. Thank you for your time, your leadership, and your continued support of students.
>
> — Zackary Mark, AVID Scholar, Sun Prairie West High School, (608) 940 7356, school account

Responses recorded: Mezei — none recorded. Dorner — none recorded. Fowler — none recorded.

Response from Ms. Peters

Do most students feel safe at school? In my opinion as a teacher, I feel about 60-70% of students feel safe. Safety to me could mean a few different things to different students. 1. Do they feel they are in a safe space overall to learn? Are they protected from the outside world? Active threats like people coming into the school to hurt them or others? 2. Do they feel they are in a safe space to learn within their classes? Are they comfortable with their peers enough to be vulnerable to learn? Are there people either harassing them or bullying them? Or are people just being jerks and unkind (which is still not ok, but not the level of bullying)? 3. Do students feel they have adults they can connect with if they feel threatened for either reason 1 or 2? 4. Are the adults in the building able to actually help the student? How do we make sure we don't have adults in the building who have questionable boundaries, or worse, manipulate students for their own gain? Or, even passively just ignore students' concerns?

If a serious concern occurred, do students generally feel comfortable reporting it to an adult? I think some students do. Usually, those students have been raised in safe spaces with adults who protect them and care for their needs, which makes them feel safe. However, we have students who are going to question everything a person does, even an adult, because of their past experiences. We can't change that, so how do we make students know that we aren't going to be a threat to them like perhaps adults in their past have been? Additionally, with everything that has happened in our school over the last few years, I feel students have every right to be wary of trusting adults, especially the adults who allow students to cross unhealthy boundaries (for instance, teachers that give students their personal cell number).

Are student concerns consistently heard and followed up on? No. I think some students' concerns are heard, but that typically comes from certain groups of students that administration pays more attention to for one reason or another. One example would be students whose caregivers are VERY VOCAL when something doesn't go their way and they threaten to make something public in the media because of it.

One change that could most improve student safety, trust, or communication: New superintendent; new district leadership; new principal. More training for staff on how to help students address their problems. More accountability on staff to have healthy boundaries with students, while still maintaining healthy working relationships with them. More accountability on students for their behavior so that all students feel safe and can learn their best while in school.

Student Responses (word for word)

Question sent: "Hey! Quick question for a student project I'm working on with the district about safety and student voice. Do you mind answering a few super short questions? Do you feel safe at school most of the time? If something serious happened, would you feel comfortable telling an adult? Do you feel like adults actually listen when students report problems? What's one thing you would change to make school feel safer or better? Totally optional, just trying to make sure real voices are heard. Thanks :)"

Response 1: "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen. Something I would do is make them get cops to pat people down before they enter cuz people be pulling up with knives."

Response 2: "Yes I do feel safe at school most of the time. I would not feel uncomfortable telling an adult. Yes I do like it when adults actually listen to the problems students report. I would add reminders for students that this is a safe space just so they do not forget and always know where to look for if they need a safe space."

Outreach to a fellow student (02/11/2026)

Zackary asked a fellow student from the Act 95 group to answer the same questions, share them with other students, and possibly attend a few meetings.

That student's reply (02/16/2026): "Most of the time yeah [I feel safe]. Depends on the adult and what happened... Yes [adults listen], because they are legally obligated to. Might not be because they think it is right or they care." His one change: actually monitor the bathrooms, where students gather to vape.

Meeting 1 Script — Student Advocacy Meeting (30 minutes, word-for-word with pauses)

Purpose: Student safety, trust, communication, and influence in district leadership decisions (superintendent & SPWHS principal searches). Goal: one concrete next step + follow-up plan.

0:00–2:00 — Opening & Purpose. "Thank you all for taking the time to meet today. [pause] I really appreciate your willingness to engage with students directly about districtwide concerns. [pause] The goal of this conversation is partnership and improvement in student safety, communication, and leadership processes. [pause] This isn't about pointing fingers at anyone — it's about understanding the system and making it better for everyone. [pause] Specifically, I want to talk about: how students experience safety and trust in schools; how student voice is heard and followed up on; and how leadership transitions, like the superintendent and SPWHS principal searches, can strengthen student trust and community engagement."

2:00–8:00 — Student Concerns Overview. "I've organized districtwide student concerns into three main themes:

1. Safety & Communication — Students often rely on rumors or social media after incidents. Limited student-facing explanation after serious events. Students aren't always sure how safety systems prevent future harm.
2. Consistency & Accountability Across Schools — Discipline and follow-up can feel inconsistent. Reports of bullying or harassment are not always clearly addressed. Students notice adults aren't always held to the same standards.
3. Student Voice & Follow-Through — Some positive steps exist, like feedback opportunities, but many students aren't aware. Limited structured voice for younger students. Students sometimes feel heard symbolically rather than systemically.

These themes are being experienced across multiple schools, not just SPWHS."

8:00–18:00 — Clarifying Questions & Dialogue.

- A. Safety Communication: "How is student communication decided after serious incidents?" "Is there a consistent district process or timeline?"
- B. Accountability & Consistency: "How are complaints about staff or administrators reviewed?" "How does the district ensure consistent follow-through across schools?"
- C. Leadership Transitions: "With the superintendent search and SPWHS principal search underway, how are student perspectives being incorporated into these decisions?" "How can community engagement strengthen trust during these transitions?"
- D. Student Voice Moving Forward: "How will feedback from this conversation lead to concrete action?" "What ongoing structure ensures continued collaboration with students across all schools?"

18:00–26:00 — Propose Concrete Next Steps. "I'd like to focus on one primary next step and a backup. Options could include: districtwide student climate listening sessions; a clear student-facing safety communication protocol; an ongoing student advisory group with admin involvement; input opportunities for students in leadership searches. Which of these feels most realistic to begin with, and what would the timeline look like?"

26:00–29:00 — Lock in Follow-Up. Confirm the agreed next step, who is responsible, the timeline/date for follow-up, and how students will be updated on progress.

29:00–30:00 — Closing. "Thank you again for collaborating with students today. We're committed to strengthening student safety, trust, and engagement districtwide, and we look forward to continued partnership and follow-through."

Meeting 2 — Follow-Up Meeting Script (30 minutes)

Opening (0:00–2:00): Thank you again for meeting previously and for the time and care you've given to these concerns. My hope for today is to briefly review what progress has been made since February 25, look at any early outcomes for students, and then identify the next clear step and timeline moving forward.

Progress Since Last Meeting (2:00–10:00): What specific actions have taken place since our last meeting related to student safety communication, consistency in follow-up to concerns, and opportunities for student voice or feedback? Who has been involved, what timelines are in progress, and what might students or families begin to notice changing?

Evidence of Impact for Students (10:00–18:00): Are there any early signs of impact, even small ones — clearer communication, planned listening opportunities, steps toward surveys or feedback systems, clarified processes for handling concerns? If larger changes are still developing, what is the most realistic first visible step within the next 30 days?

Identifying the Next Concrete Step (18:00–26:00): One clear next action, for example scheduling a student listening session, developing a draft student communication framework, piloting a student climate or trust survey, or creating an ongoing student advisory structure. What feels most achievable, and what timeline makes sense?

Confirming Follow-Through (26:00–29:00): Confirm the agreed-upon next step, who is responsible, the expected timeline, and how students will be updated.

Closing (29:00–30:00): Thank you again for your time, your openness to this conversation, and your continued support of students.

Questions to Ask — Measuring Impact

1. Whether students pay attention: surveys or polls ("Did you hear about this?" "Do you know how to report concerns?"); participation tracking (Student Voices, town halls, board meetings); informal feedback from friends and student groups.
2. Whether students speak up: track Student Voices attendance and who speaks; keep a record of questions, comments, or emails sent to the board/district; check anonymous reporting tools; ask clubs, AVID classes, or advisory groups if students feel comfortable sharing concerns.
3. Whether the district follows through: updates from the board/district (newsletters, emails, websites); meeting minutes mentioning changes to policies, the behavior matrix, or safety plans; visible changes in classrooms, hallways, or offices; follow-up telling students how their feedback led to action.

Tracking sheet:

- Students paying attention — Survey, meeting attendance — Track % who respond

- Students speaking up — Number of comments/questions/emails — Track trends over time
- District follow-through — Emails, website updates, classroom observations — Look for concrete actions

Student Senate Restart Framework

STUDENT SENATE RESTART FRAMEWORK (PHASE I) — Sun Prairie West High School

This document outlines a phased relaunch of the Student Senate at Sun Prairie West High School, utilizing a gradual and sustainable model that will begin in April. Phase I focuses on rebuilding systems, establishing credibility, and strengthening student–administration collaboration before expanding to a full representative body.

The restart model prioritizes sustainability, consistency, achievable goals, and administrative partnership over immediate scale.

I. Purpose

The Student Senate exists to provide structured student input on school improvement, policy feedback, and campus climate.

During Phase I, the Senate will operate as a small pilot advisory team rather than a full legislative body.

II. Core Objectives (Phase I)

1. Re-establish consistent student–administration dialogue.
2. Create repeatable and documented meeting systems.
3. Complete one measurable improvement initiative.
4. Build student awareness and trust in the Senate process.
5. Develop a foundation for gradual expansion in Phase II.
6. Represent diverse student perspectives across grade levels and involvement areas.
7. Provide structured input on school policies, academic systems, and improvement initiatives.
8. Review and respond to student concerns in a systematic and documented manner.
9. Partner with administration in school improvement planning.
10. Promote transparency between students and school leadership.

Definition of a Measurable Initiative: A measurable initiative must include:

- A clearly defined problem
- Documented student input
- A written recommendation
- A tracked outcome or administrative response

III. Authority & Scope

The Student Senate holds formal advisory authority in the following areas:

- Academic policies (grading feedback, weighted GPA structures, scheduling feedback)
- Student climate and equity initiatives
- School improvement planning
- Student discipline framework feedback

- Resource allocation input affecting students
- Facilities and campus improvement suggestions

The Senate does not override administrative decisions. However, the Senate should be consulted on major student-impacting changes when feasible prior to final implementation.

IV. Structure (Phase I Model)

A. Membership

Phase I will consist of a small founding team of 4–6 students selected through a brief application and interview process.

Selection Criteria:

- Demonstrated leadership, initiative, or engagement
- Representation across at least two grade levels
- Commitment to structured work sessions
- Willingness to collaborate respectfully with staff

The goal is diversity of perspective, not size.

B. Terms

- One semester pilot term (April–June)
- End-of-semester evaluation
- Decision on Phase II expansion based on performance and feasibility

C. Expansion Plan (Phase II Consideration)

If Phase I meets its objectives, Phase II may introduce:

- Additional grade-level seats
- A small committee system
- Increased membership to 8–12 students

V. Leadership Roles

- President – Facilitates meetings; sets agendas with advisor and administration; serves as primary liaison.
- Vice President – Assists President; supports coordination and internal operations.
- Secretary – Records and publishes meeting minutes; maintains documentation archive.
- Communications Lead – Provides public updates to the student body.
- Committee Chairs – Established in Phase II if needed.

VI. Meetings & Decision Rules

Meeting Schedule (Phase I):

- Full Senate meets bi-weekly (short, focused sessions).
- One formal SP100 preparatory meeting before the staff review period.

Agendas must be published 24–48 hours before meetings. Minutes must be published within 72 hours after meetings.

Decision Rules:

- Quorum: A majority of members must be present.
- Recommendations: Adopted by simple majority vote.
- Framework Amendments: Require a two-thirds vote and administrative approval.
- The President votes only in the event of a tie.

Attendance Policy:

- Attendance is recorded internally.
- After two unexcused absences, membership status will be reviewed.

VII. Proposal Process

1. An issue is submitted by a student or senator.
2. The issue is reviewed during a scheduled meeting.
3. A draft recommendation is prepared.
4. The recommendation is reviewed by the President and Advisor.
5. A final written brief is submitted to administration for review and discussion.

All proposals must be documented and archived.

VIII. Transparency & Accountability

- Meeting notes are accessible to members and the advisor.
- A brief public summary is shared after any formal administrative review.
- Documentation is maintained in a shared digital archive.

At the conclusion of Phase I, all meeting minutes, reports, and recommendations will be archived in a shared digital folder maintained by the advisor to ensure continuity.

IX. Code of Conduct

Senators must:

- Represent peers respectfully
- Maintain confidentiality when required
- Avoid conflicts of interest
- Engage in civil, solution-focused dialogue
- Prioritize school-wide impact over personal agenda

X. Advisor Role

The Faculty Advisor:

- Ensures continuity and structural stability
- Supports logistics and communication
- Coordinates staff interactions
- Maintains documentation archives
- Does not control votes or recommendations

XI. Staff Partnership Structure

A. Core Staff Advisory Group

May include:

- Principal
- Assistant Principal(s)
- Dean of Students (if applicable)
- School Improvement Lead
- One rotating teacher representative

B. SP100 Participation Protocol (Phase I)

- The Senate will submit a written briefing aligned with the SP100 meeting cycle (June, November, March).
- The President may attend as an observer if invited.
- A written summary of feedback or next steps will be shared within five school days when appropriate.

Phase I prioritizes written briefing participation over full meeting integration.

XII. Evaluation & Transition

At the end of Phase I:

- Review accomplishments and measurable outcomes
- Identify unresolved initiatives
- Document lessons learned
- Assess readiness for Phase II expansion
- Archive all materials for continuity

XIII. Amendment Process

- Two-thirds vote of active Senate members
- Administrative approval required
- Public posting of approved amendments

Adopted: _____ Phase I Review Date: _____ Quarterly Review: _____

Meeting log template

Student Senate meeting log template.

Agendas

Date: _____

Minutes

Date: _____

SP100

Date: _____

Public Reports (April 2026)

Report A — Student Advocacy and Progress Report (April 2026)

Sun Prairie Area School District (SPASD). Prepared by: Zackary Mark. Date: April 2026.

Executive Summary

Since January 2026, student-led advocacy has driven measurable progress toward stronger student safety, trust, transparency, communication consistency, and authentic student voice within the Sun Prairie Area School District. Beginning with a formal proposal to the Board of Education and advancing through collaborative meetings and structured initiatives, these efforts have resulted in the launch of the Student Senate at Sun Prairie West High School, expanded student participation in leadership selection, and ongoing work to improve district systems.

While foundational steps have been achieved, several areas remain in development. Sustained implementation, clear accountability measures, and districtwide scaling will be critical to embedding student perspectives into SPASD's operations and creating long-term improvements in school climate.

Purpose of This Report

The purpose of this report is to document the journey of student-led advocacy, highlight concrete progress made to date, provide transparency on current initiatives, and outline clear recommendations for sustained improvement. It serves as both a record of achievements and a roadmap to ensure student voice translates into meaningful, long-term systems that enhance school climate, safety, and shared decision-making across SPASD.

Key Definitions

- Student Voice: The structured and meaningful inclusion of student perspectives in school climate, safety, communication, and decision-making processes.
- Student Safety and Trust Framework: The January 2026 proposal submitted to the Board of Education that outlines actionable steps for improved incident communication, consistent safety protocols, transparent reporting, formal student advisory structures, and proactive mental health supports.
- Student Senate: A formal, elected representative body designed to provide ongoing student input on school-related issues, collaborate with administration, and contribute to problem-solving and goal-setting.
- Shared Decision-Making: The practice of including students, alongside administrators and the Board, in leadership selection, policy development, and continuous improvement efforts.

1. Background and Timeline of Student Advocacy

Student concerns regarding school climate, safety, communication after serious incidents, and consistency in district practices prompted structured advocacy efforts.

- January 13, 2026: Submission of the "Student Safety, Trust, and a Proposed Framework" to the SPASD Board of Education. The proposal addressed gaps in incident communication, reporting transparency, cross-building consistency, student advisory structures, mental health supports, and continuous improvement processes.
- January–February 2026: Individual responses received from Board members affirm the importance of transparency and student voice.
- March 2, 2026: Student Advocacy Meeting with district leadership. The agenda focused on safety and communication systems, consistency and accountability across schools, and the role of student voice in leadership decisions.
- March–April 2026: Follow-up communications on Student Senate development, mandated reporting clarity, and student involvement in the Sun Prairie West High School principal search.
- April 2026: Rollout of the Student Senate interest form, application period, elections, and coordination of student participation in principal interviews.

2. Student Safety, Trust, and Proposed Framework

The January 2026 framework proposed a comprehensive, DPI-aligned approach to rebuilding trust. Core components:

- Clear acknowledgment and communication when serious incidents occur, even when full details cannot be shared.
- Districtwide overview of safety and reporting processes, including roles of administration, district leadership, and external authorities.
- Consistent implementation of safety and conduct protocols across all schools to address observed variations in handling similar situations.
- Strengthened student voice through formal advisory structures at middle and high school levels with required administrative responses.
- Proactive mental health and wellness supports, including regular advisory time and accessible counseling pathways.
- Ongoing review and reflection via regular climate surveys, transparent reporting, and public discussion of improvement efforts.

Board Response (January 20, 2026): The Board acknowledged the concerns, emphasized legal/privacy constraints, highlighted actions already taken (such as releasing independent investigator reports and maintaining a dedicated FAQ website), and committed to continued attention through school liaisons and student representative recruitment.

Current Status: Transparency initiatives are advancing, with district leadership focusing on clearer student-facing communication regarding reporting escalation, parent notifications, and post-incident messaging.

3. Student Advocacy Meeting Outcomes (March 2, 2026)

The meeting established a foundation for collaborative, solution-oriented engagement. Primary discussion areas included student safety and communication systems; consistency and accountability in districtwide practices; and integration of student perspectives into leadership decisions and formal processes. The meeting shifted focus from identifying concerns to developing structured next steps with measurable outcomes.

4. Establishment of the Student Senate

District leadership initiated planning for a representative Student Senate to institutionalize student input beyond one-time feedback opportunities.

- Introduced in April 2026 for full implementation in the 2026–2027 school year.
- Composition: Three students per grade level (9th, 10th, and 11th graders serving in the following year) plus additional members from student clubs and organizations.
- Selection Process: Student-wide elections following an interest/application period (deadline April 22, 2026). Elections held April 27, 2026, with a revised ballot issued to correct initial technical errors.
- Purpose and Goals: Serve as a formal voice for peers; identify school climate concerns; collaborate with administration on communication systems and problem-solving; develop concrete goals and strategic action plans.

Elected representatives were announced April 29, 2026: three incoming seniors, three incoming juniors, and three incoming sophomores.

Observations: High student interest was evident. However, initial ballot errors temporarily affected trust in the process. Discussions also explored incorporating students from Act 95 and the Weighted GPA initiative groups.

5. Student Involvement in Leadership Selection

A significant milestone was the invitation for students to participate in the Sun Prairie West High School principal interview process. Interview dates (April 3 and April 7, 2026) were coordinated, providing students a direct opportunity to evaluate leadership candidates on priorities including safety, communication, and student voice.

6. Communication and Transparency Initiatives

District leadership is actively addressing inconsistencies in how information reaches students following incidents and clarifying student services processes. Focus areas:

- Evaluation of existing communication protocols and identification of gaps in student-facing messaging.
- Increased clarity on mandated reporting: when and how reports escalate to external agencies, parent/guardian notification procedures, and accessible information for students.
- Development of more timely, consistent, and transparent communication systems.

Current Status: These improvements remain in progress and constitute a critical area for building long-term trust.

7. Challenges and Observations

- Transition from informal feedback to structured involvement is underway, but success depends on administrative timelines and system capacity.
- Technical issues during Student Senate elections highlighted the need for robust process review.
- Popular election promotes broad participation but may benefit from hybrid selection methods to better include highly engaged students.
- Student Senate provides an important avenue for voice, yet complementary structures are needed to fully utilize experienced advocates and prevent over-reliance on a single body.

8. Recommendations

- Institutionalize the Student Senate with clear governance, meeting schedules, defined influence on school decisions, and mechanisms for administrative accountability.
- Expand Student Voice Pathways by creating additional advisory, liaison, and committee roles to complement the Senate.
- Enhance Election and Selection Processes through rigorous pre-launch review and consideration of hybrid models (application + election).
- Advance Communication Systems by finalizing standardized protocols for incident response and student services transparency, with regular updates to the community.
- Strengthen Accountability via regular progress reporting, climate surveys, 100-day goal check-ins, and measurable indicators.
- Scale Districtwide by extending successful practices, such as student participation in principal and superintendent searches, to other schools and levels.

9. Survey

The bilingual "Student Advocacy Feedback / Comentarios sobre la defensa de los estudiantes" form is reproduced in full in the Surveys & Feedback part of this document. Respondent link: https://forms.gle/pQsxiPcCcrp9tB1j6

Conclusion

The advocacy efforts of recent months illustrate the power of persistent, constructive student engagement when met with responsive district leadership. The proposed Safety and Trust Framework, Student Advocacy Meeting, launch of the Student Senate, and student involvement in principal selection mark important progress toward a more transparent, consistent, and student-centered school district.

Long-term success will depend on converting these early initiatives into embedded systems. By maintaining collaboration, ensuring accountability, and prioritizing student voice in decision-making processes, SPASD can establish a model of shared responsibility that enhances safety, trust, and educational excellence for all students.

Report B — Student Advocacy Report #2: Progress Update on Student Voice, Communication, and Leadership Engagement

Executive Summary

Following the initial Student Advocacy Meeting, continued efforts have been made to advance districtwide priorities related to student voice, communication transparency, and system-level consistency. While several initiatives remain in development, meaningful steps have been taken to integrate student perspectives into both ongoing discussions and formal leadership processes.

Background

The March 2, 2026 Student Advocacy Meeting established a foundation for collaborative engagement between students and district leadership, focused on student safety and communication systems; consistency and accountability across schools; and the role of student voice in leadership decisions and district processes. The goal was not only to identify concerns, but to transition toward structured, solution-oriented next steps with measurable outcomes.

Progress & Developments

1. Exploration of a Districtwide Student Senate — District leadership has initiated discussions regarding the reestablishment of a Student Senate framework. Current considerations include incorporating students involved in recent district initiatives, including Act 95 and Weighted GPA discussions. Emphasis is on a more consistent, representative, and sustainable structure, moving beyond one-time feedback toward an ongoing, system-level student advisory model.
2. Student Involvement in Leadership Selection — Students have been invited to participate in the Sun Prairie West High School principal interview process. This creates a direct opportunity to influence leadership priorities, values, and communication approaches.
3. Student Services & Communication Transparency (In Progress) — District leadership is working to provide increased clarity regarding student services processes, particularly mandated reporting: when and how reports are escalated to external/state agencies; when and how parents/guardians are notified; and how information is communicated to students clearly.
4. Continued Focus on Communication Systems — Initial discussions highlighted inconsistencies in how information is communicated to students following incidents. Priorities: evaluating existing protocols, identifying gaps in student-facing communication, and exploring more consistent, timely, and transparent messaging.

Current Status Overview

- Student Senate development → In progress (early-stage planning)
- Student involvement in leadership processes → Active and ongoing
- Communication and transparency improvements → In development
- System-level implementation → Pending further structure and follow-up

Key Observations

- There is a clear shift from informal student feedback toward structured student involvement.
- Progress is present, though dependent on administrative timelines and system capacity.
- Early-stage efforts will require sustained attention to ensure they translate into long-term systems rather than temporary initiatives.

Priority Areas Moving Forward

- Establishing a clear structure and timeline for Student Senate implementation
- Ensuring transparency and accessibility in student-facing communication systems
- Expanding and sustaining student involvement in leadership and decision-making processes
- Maintaining accountability through defined follow-ups and measurable progress indicators

Conclusion

Student voice is most effective when it is not only heard, but embedded into the processes that shape the district. Continued collaboration between students and district leadership will be essential in ensuring that progress remains steady, measurable, and aligned with the needs of the broader student community.

Report C — Public Report on Student Safety, Voice, and Communication (February 2026)

Prepared by: Zackary Mark, Student Representative. Status: Public Community Document.

I. Purpose

The purpose of this report is to document student-led efforts to understand and strengthen student safety (physical, emotional, and psychological), student voice in decision-making, and communication transparency between students, staff, families, and district leadership. This report is not an accusation against any individual or institution. Its purpose is constructive transparency and continuous improvement in support of students.

II. Definitions

- Student Safety includes physical protection, emotional wellbeing, and confidence that school systems will respond appropriately to concerns.
- Student Voice refers to structured opportunities for student perspectives to meaningfully influence school or district decisions.
- Transparency is clear, timely, and accessible communication of processes, actions, and outcomes within legal privacy limits.
- Accountability means consistent policy implementation, visible follow-through on concerns, and equitable standards across schools.

III. Background

During the 2025–2026 school year, student discussions within SPASD highlighted recurring themes: questions about how safety concerns are reported and addressed; uncertainty about whether student reports lead to visible action; and desire for stronger student involvement in district decisions. In response, a student-led engagement effort was initiated to gather voluntary perspectives and encourage constructive dialogue with district leadership.

IV. Method of Engagement

Direct outreach to middle and high school students; voluntary written student responses to standardized safety questions; outreach to teachers, staff, and administrators; public community communication via social media; and preparation for collaborative meetings with district leadership. Participation has been voluntary and informal at this stage.

V. Preliminary Observations (Non-Statistical)

Many students report feeling generally safe physically. Some students express uncertainty about adult follow-through. Concerns exist regarding whether reports are consistently heard. Students show interest in clearer procedures and communication.

VI. Risks and Limitations

Small and voluntary response sample; possible participation bias; ongoing data collection; privacy laws restricting the disclosure of incidents; variation in experiences across schools.

VII. Actions Completed to Date

Initiated student-led safety and voice inquiry; developed a standardized student question set; collected initial voluntary student responses; conducted outreach to staff and administrators; began community awareness through social media; prepared documentation for district discussion.

VIII. Actions Currently in Progress

Continued student response collection; expansion of outreach to additional schools and grade levels; preparation for February 25 administrative meeting; organization of documentation and communication materials.

IX. Actions Recommended Next (0–90 Days)

- Immediate (0–30 days): Conduct a district-supported student listening session or distribute a brief student climate and trust survey.
- Short term (30–60 days): Public summary of themes that protects confidentiality; identification of priority safety and communication needs.
- Near term (60–90 days): Establish an ongoing student advisory or feedback structure; define clear communication pathways for student concerns.

X. Social Media and Community Engagement Status

Public informational posts inviting voluntary participation; encouragement of student, family, and staff dialogue; emphasis on constructive collaboration rather than criticism. Engagement remains early-stage but positive.

XI. Relationships and Collaboration

Respectful outreach to students across grade levels, teachers and school staff, school and district administrators, and families and community members, emphasizing voluntary participation, respectful dialogue, and shared commitment to student wellbeing.

XIII. Good-Faith Statement

All actions described in this report were conducted in good faith with the intent to improve student safety and wellbeing, strengthen trust and communication, and support collaborative solutions within SPASD. No portion of this report is intended to defame, accuse, or target any individual.

XIV. Conclusion

This student-led effort represents an early but meaningful step toward greater transparency, stronger student voice, and improved trust in safety systems. Sustained engagement, structured data collection, and clear communication will be essential to long-term progress.

XV. Public Release Notice

This document is suitable for community awareness, educational discussion, administrative planning, and civic learning and student leadership development. It should be interpreted as a constructive public report, not a legal claim.

Meeting Packet: Dr. Taren Turner (August 27)

STUDENT VOICE • STRONGER TOGETHER — Meeting Brief & Discussion Guide Zackary Mark + Dr. Turner. Thursday, August 27, 2026, 11:30 AM–12:30 PM, District Support Center.

Purpose of the Meeting

Use this hour to discuss how student voice can become a consistent part of district decision-making, student leadership, communication, and school improvement. The goal is not simply to identify concerns, but to identify practical structures, opportunities, and next steps that can create lasting student–district collaboration.

Opening Message

I appreciate the opportunity to meet with district leadership. My goal is to bring a student perspective to conversations about how SPASD can strengthen communication, trust, student leadership, and meaningful involvement. I am especially interested in turning student input into something that is consistently connected to decisions and follow-through.

Proposed Discussion Agenda

- 11:30–11:40 | Welcome, introductions, and purpose — Establish the goal for the conversation and identify the most important priorities.
- 11:40–12:20 | Core discussion — Work through student voice, leadership, engagement, Student Senate follow-up, district initiatives, and school climate.
- 12:20–12:30 | Next steps and closing — Identify concrete action items, responsible people, communication, and a path for continued collaboration.

Priority Discussion Areas

1. Student voice & decision-making — How can student perspectives be heard earlier and reflected more consistently in district decisions?
2. Student leadership & advocacy — What structures, supports, and opportunities can help students lead and advocate effectively across SPASD?
3. Engagement & communication — How can communication between students, administrators, and the Board become more consistent, transparent, and two-way?
4. Student Senate & engagement follow-up — What has happened since the Student Senate/student engagement work, what is in motion, and what needs to happen next?
5. District programs, policies & initiatives — Which areas could benefit most from direct student input before decisions are finalized?
6. Climate, belonging, safety & trust — How can students contribute constructively to conversations about school climate, belonging, safety, and trust?
7. Continued collaboration — What ongoing structure could keep student leaders and district leadership connected after this meeting?

Questions to Drive the Conversation

1. What does meaningful student involvement look like to you at the district level?
2. Where does SPASD currently have the strongest student voice, and where is there the biggest gap?
3. How can students be involved before a decision is made rather than only asked for feedback afterward?
4. What would make student leadership sustainable instead of dependent on individual students or staff members?
5. How should student feedback be communicated back to students so they know what changed, what did not, and why?
6. What should the next phase of Student Senate/student engagement work look like?
7. Are there district policies, programs, or initiatives where student input could be incorporated immediately?
8. What is the best way for students to contribute to conversations about safety, belonging, trust, and school climate?
9. Who should be responsible for maintaining an ongoing student–district feedback loop?
10. What is one concrete action we can take after this meeting that would demonstrate that student voice is being taken seriously?

Desired Outcomes

- A clear priority area for continued student–district collaboration.
- Specific next steps, with responsible people and an expected timeline where possible.
- A practical pathway for students to provide input on district decisions and initiatives.
- A plan for continued communication between student leaders, administrators, and district leadership.
- Clarity on the next phase of Student Senate/student engagement work.

Key Principle

Student voice should move beyond being heard to being meaningfully connected to action.

Notes & Commitments: _____

Meeting Packet: Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed

Student Perspective on District Engagement & Improvement Prepared for: Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent. Prepared by: Zackary Mark, Sun Prairie West High School

Executive Summary

The Student Voice Initiative is a student-led effort focused on strengthening communication, transparency, trust, and meaningful student engagement across the Sun Prairie Area School District.

The goal is to ensure student voice is not only heard, but consistently reflected in district conversations and long-term decision-making.

Work Completed

- Developed and launched the SPASD Student Voice initiative.
- Created district-wide social media platforms to share information, encourage discussion, and promote student engagement.
- Designed a bilingual student feedback survey to gather perspectives from students, families, staff, and community members.
- Worked with district leadership on topics including student engagement, communication, transparency, school climate, trust, and leadership collaboration.

Prior Areas of Involvement

- Student leadership discussions
- Communication improvement efforts
- Student engagement frameworks
- School climate conversations
- Student advocacy initiatives
- District leadership collaboration

Current Priorities

- Stronger student voice
- Increased collaboration between students and district leadership
- Greater transparency around district decisions
- Sustainable student engagement systems
- Student feedback that results in visible action

Looking Ahead

Potential next steps include exploring:

- A District Student Advisory Council
- Regular student-district meetings
- Structured opportunities for student input

- Public updates demonstrating how student feedback informs district decisions

Purpose

Student Voice should move beyond occasional feedback and become a consistent, transparent, and meaningful part of how SPASD listens, collaborates, and improves.

Discussion Topics & Questions — Meeting with Dr. Antoine Reed

Student Voice

- What does a meaningful student voice look like under your leadership?
- How do you envision students contributing to district-level decision-making?
- What opportunities do you see for students to regularly collaborate with district leadership?

Communication & Transparency

- What improvements would you most like to make regarding communication with students?
- How can communication become more consistent across all SPASD schools?
- How can students better understand why district decisions are made?

Student Advisory Council

- Would you be open to exploring a district-wide Student Advisory Council?
- What would you want that structure to accomplish?
- How could it remain sustainable through future leadership transitions?

School Climate & Trust

- What do you believe builds trust between students and district leadership?
- Where do you believe SPASD has made progress?
- Where do you see the greatest opportunities for improvement?

Looking Ahead

- What are your priorities during your first year as Superintendent?
- How can students help support those priorities?
- What would successful student engagement look like one year from now?

Student Voice Project

- How could the Student Voice project complement existing district engagement efforts?
- Are there opportunities to share student feedback or ideas with district leadership on a regular basis?
- How can student-led initiatives best support the district while remaining constructive and solution-focused?

Closing Questions

- Is there anything you would like students to better understand about district leadership?
- What advice would you give to students who want to become involved in improving their schools?

- What are the best next steps to continue this conversation and build a long-term partnership?

Contact Information

Zackary Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School

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Thank you for taking the time to meet and discuss the future of student engagement within SPASD. I appreciate the opportunity to share student perspectives and look forward to continuing to work collaboratively to strengthen communication, trust, and meaningful student voice across the district.

Student Advocacy Report #3: Fall 2026 Update

Published on the SPASD Student Voice website. Covers late April through October 8, 2026.

Summary

The biggest change since spring: SPASD's new superintendent, Dr. Antoine Reed, is open to a district-wide Student Advisory Council. Students also helped interview the superintendent finalists, the weighted grades work restarted this fall, and the Director of School Operations offered to help build a student-rights guide.

One thing is still stuck. Mandated-reporting information promised in March hasn't been shared. On the good side, a meeting with the district's equity and communications leaders is now set for October 20.

Student Advisory Council

On April 13, high school students met the three superintendent finalists and gave feedback. In a meeting this fall, Dr. Reed shared ideas for student voice:

- Two-way conversation and quarterly meetings with students
- Advisory teams of 3–5 students from each middle and high school, plus a parent team at each school
- More communication channels, including the district app and a shared calendar
- Building the council into the culture so it lasts through leadership changes

Next step: a written proposal for how members are chosen, how often they meet, and how the district responds to them.

Weighted grades

A student and staff work group aims to bring a weighted grades framework to the Board by the end of November, in time for the December course guides. The group agreed on a 5.0 scale for weighted courses and is writing criteria rather than picking classes one by one. A caregiver survey, in English and Spanish, goes out in October.

Student rights and Title IX

After the federal Title IX change, the district confirmed that its own nondiscrimination and anti-bullying policies still protect students based on sexual orientation, gender identity, and other protected classes. Students can report concerns through Speak Up Speak Out. The Director of School Operations offered to help create a plain-language student-rights guide.

How the budget works

From an August 18 meeting with the Director of Business & Finance: about 80% of spending is staff, enrollment drives revenue, and state aid per student isn't tied to inflation. A separate one-page explainer is on the site.

Still waiting

- Student-facing information on mandated reporting (asked March 2)

Coming up: a meeting with the district's equity and communications leaders on October 20.

Next 60 days

- Send Dr. Reed a Student Advisory Council proposal
- Start the student-rights guide
- Help finish the weighted grades framework
- Share a summary of survey results

District Emails (Sept.–Oct. 2026)

E-053 · Follow-Up: Student Voice & District Engagement

From Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>

To Zackary Mark (school account)

Cc Marlita Bevenue <mabeven@sunprairieschools.org>, Dr. Michael Morgan <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Sep 8, 2026, 1:10 PM

Hello Zackary,

Thank you for your patience. I am writing to you on behalf of Strategic Communications Director Marlita Bevenue and Systemic Equity & Inclusion Director Dr. Michael Morgan to help set up a time for the three of you to meet.

They apologize for the delay in following up on your initial email — it has been a very busy start to the school year — but they are very excited to reconnect with you. They want to learn more about the work you have been doing, hear about your goals, and discuss how your vision can support student voice and engagement across the district. Their goal for this meeting is to build a shared understanding before mapping out potential next steps together.

We can schedule this either in person or virtually. To make sure we don't pull you away from your studies, we would like to coordinate a time during lunch or outside from your core academic classes.

Please let me know:

- Format preference: In-person or Virtual
- Your availability: 3 times over the next 2 weeks during non-core class times (i.e. lunch)

Once you let me know what works best for your schedule, I will schedule a meeting based on everyone's availability and send you a calendar confirmation. If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to reach out.

Thank you!

Pao, Administrative Associate, The Department of Systemic Equity & Inclusion (She/Hers)

E-054 · Re: Follow-Up: Student Voice & District Engagement

From Zackary Mark (school account)

To Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>

Cc Marlita Bevenue <mabeven@sunprairieschools.org>, Michael Morgan <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>

Date Sep 8, 2026, 1:20 PM

Hello,

Thank you for reaching out and for coordinating this meeting. I really appreciate the opportunity to reconnect and speak with Dr. Bevenue and Dr. Morgan about the work I have been doing around student voice, communication, and school climate.

I would prefer to meet in person, as I think that would allow for a more productive conversation and give us the opportunity to discuss the ideas and potential next steps in greater depth.

My availability over the next two weeks during non-core class times is:

- A Days: 12:15–3:50 p.m.
- B Days: 12:15–3:50 p.m.

I am flexible within those windows, so any three times that work best for everyone's schedules should work well for me.

I am looking forward to sharing more about the Student Advocacy & School Climate Feedback survey, the ideas I have been developing around a district-wide Student Advisory Council, and how I believe student voice can become a sustainable part of SPASD's decision-making and communication processes.

Thank you again for coordinating this. I appreciate the opportunity and look forward to meeting with everyone.

Best, Zackary Mark Student Advocate | Sun Prairie West High School | Instagram: SPASD Student Voice

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E-055 · Re: [Student] Re: Follow-Up: Student Voice & District Engagement

From	Carolyn Pao <cmpao@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Cc	Marlita Bevenue, Dr. Michael Morgan
Date	Sep 8, 2026, 2:15 PM

Thank you Zackary for the quick response and I will coordinate with Marlita and Dr. Morgan on what date and time would best work for them. I will also need some additional time to coordinate with the West High staff to ensure we can reserve one of the conference rooms as well. Please standby and my goal is to update you before the end of the week.

Best, Pao

E-056 · Questions Regarding Recent Title IX Changes and LGBTQIA+ Student Protections

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Title IX Coordinator <titleixcoordinator@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Sep 29, 2026, 8:25 PM

Dear Title IX Coordinator,

I'm reaching out because I have some questions about the recent federal changes to Title IX and what those changes mean for LGBTQIA+ students in the Sun Prairie Area School District.

With the federal government reinstating the 2020 Title IX regulations, I want to better understand how SPASD is interpreting and implementing these changes at the district level. In particular, I'm hoping the district can clarify:

- Whether the recent federal changes affect any protections or policies currently provided to students based on sexual orientation or gender identity.
- Whether SPASD's existing nondiscrimination policies and protections for LGBTQIA+ students remain in effect.

- Whether students, families, and staff should expect any changes to how discrimination, harassment, or other concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students are handled.
- What resources or support will remain available to LGBTQIA+ students if federal Title IX protections change or become more limited.

I'm asking because I think it is important for students to have a clear understanding of their rights, the district's responsibilities, and the support available to them. I also want to make sure that information being shared with students is accurate and reflects both federal requirements and the district's own policies.

If there are any updated policies, guidance, or resources related to these changes, I would appreciate being directed to them.

Thank you for taking the time to clarify this and for continuing to support students across the district.

Sincerely, Zackary Mark Student Advocate | Sun Prairie West High School | Instagram: SPASD Student Voice School Email: school account | Personal Email: zackarymark160@gmail.com | Phone: +1 (608) 940-7356

E-057 · Re: [Title IX Coordinator] [Student] Questions Regarding Recent Title IX Changes and LGBTQIA+ Student Protections

From	Tricia Rodey <tcrodey@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account)
Date	Oct 1, 2026, 9:05 PM

Hi Zackary,

Thank you for your email. I appreciate your advocacy on this important issue. Here are my answers to your questions:

- Whether the recent federal changes affect any protections or policies currently provided to students based on sexual orientation or gender identity.

I am answering this assuming you are referring to the Dept of Education decision from 9/28/26 to formally rescind the 2020 Title IX guidance. Please let me know if you are referring to other changes. A judge actually blocked the 2020 changes a year ago, so we haven't been able to use them during that time. This latest decision officially removes them from the books. However, Sun Prairie Area School District policy still includes protections for all members of protected classes (this includes classifications based on gender, sex, and gender identity). The latest move does not impact any protections or policies provided to students in our district.

- Whether SPASD's existing nondiscrimination policies and protections for LGBTQIA+ students remain in effect.

They do indeed. Title IX was one layer of protection, but our anti-bullying/anti-harassment policies are actually more robust protection and are still alive and well. The criteria for Title IX is actually very narrow and my hope is that we put an end to harassment through the aforementioned policies well before the behavior would meet the threshold for a Title IX complaint.

- Whether students, families, and staff should expect any changes to how discrimination, harassment, or other concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students are handled.

They should not. Title IX was one tool in the toolbox for addressing concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students, but we still have other tools available to us. The fact of the matter is we (administrators

in Sun Prairie) are keenly aware of the harm a hostile school environment can have on any students but particularly members of our LGBTQIA+ community. My team and I remain committed to ensuring all of our students have access to a safe and supportive school community. We've actually been working to make reporting concerns easier and more robust through changing how we use Speak Up Speak Out (SUSO) to ensure more eyes are on complaints more quickly.

- What resources or support will remain available to LGBTQIA+ students if federal Title IX protections change or become more limited.

All of the resources we have in the district remain in effect. Administrators and staff remain committed to ensuring students have access to whatever resources they need. These Title IX changes do not limit or change what we are able to offer our students.

I admire and share your goal to ensure that all students know their rights — both within and beyond the school setting. I've been looking for an in-road in SPASD to provide information to students about the rights and protections. I think Title IX is one example of a confusing legal topic, but the events at East this week also has me thinking it might be useful for students to learn more about their first amendment rights (not because those students did anything wrong, but because I want students to feel confident exercising their voice and know what is and isn't legal). If it ever fits into your schedule, would you be willing to meet with me to brainstorm what this might look like? I see your email signature says "student advocate," I am curious what that role entails and if you have an affiliation with a student activist group. I would more than welcome the opportunity to connect with activist minded students to learn how I might be helpful in supporting them in learning more about their rights. If you have any thoughts or insights on what that could look like, I would deeply appreciate them.

Thanks again for reaching out. Please don't hesitate to contact me again if I can be of assistance.

Sincerely, Dr. Rodey Tricia Rodey, Ph.D.

E-058 · Re: [Title IX Coordinator] [Student] Questions Regarding Recent Title IX Changes and LGBTQIA+ Student Protections

From	Zackary Mark (school account)
To	Tricia Rodey <tcrodey@sunprairieschools.org>
Date	Oct 1, 2026, 9:14 PM

Dear Dr. Rodey,

Thank you for taking the time to give such a detailed response. I really appreciate you answering each of my questions and clarifying how the recent federal changes interact with the protections already in place within SPASD.

It is reassuring to know that the district's nondiscrimination, anti-bullying, and anti-harassment policies remain in effect and that students should not expect changes to how concerns involving LGBTQIA+ students are handled. I also appreciate hearing about the work being done to make Speak Up Speak Out more effective and ensure that concerns receive more attention and follow-up.

When I use "Student Advocate" in my signature, I mean that I work to elevate student voices, help students understand issues that affect them, and create better communication between students and decision-makers.

Over the past several years, I have worked on a number of student and community advocacy projects. This has included gathering student feedback through surveys, working on districtwide

student-voice initiatives, sharing student concerns and recommendations with district leadership, and participating in conversations about policies that directly affect students.

I have also worked as a youth community advocate outside of the school district. Most recently, I met with Sun Prairie Police Chief Kevin Warych to discuss the department's automated license plate reader program. We discussed issues including privacy, transparency, data retention, access to information, data sharing, and the potential impact of surveillance technology on the community. I have been working to turn that conversation and the information gathered into a plain-language report so community members can better understand the program and the policies surrounding it.

I am not currently representing a formal student activist organization. Rather, I have been working independently and through student-led efforts to make sure young people have opportunities to understand policies, ask questions of decision-makers, and have their voices taken seriously.

That is also why your idea about helping students learn more about their rights really interests me. I think there could be a lot of value in creating something accessible and designed specifically for students rather than expecting them to navigate complicated legal language on their own.

For example, this could potentially include student-friendly information about Title IX, nondiscrimination and anti-harassment protections, First Amendment rights in schools, student privacy, reporting concerns, and the different district resources available to students. It could also explain the difference between federal protections and protections provided directly through district policy so students understand that their rights do not necessarily begin and end with one federal law.

I would be very interested in meeting with you to brainstorm what this could look like and how students could be involved in developing it. I also think it would be important for students themselves to have a role in deciding what information would be most useful and how it should be communicated.

Thank you again for reaching out and for being willing to have this conversation. I really appreciate the opportunity to work together on something that could help students better understand their rights and feel more confident using their voices.

Sincerely, Zackary Mark

E-059 · Invitation with note: MEETING: Student Voice & District Engagement @ Tue Oct 20, 2026 13:30–14:30 (CDT)

From	Michael Morgan (organizer) <mdmorga@sunprairieschools.org>
To	Zackary Mark (school account), Marlita Bevenue
Date	Oct 15, 2026, 7:21 AM

Note: "Thank you everyone for you collaboration and patience! Please let Pao know if this date and time needs to be adjusted if this does not work for your schedule or if there is a change. Thank you."

Conference Room: 1202

Purpose: Director Bevenue and Dr. Morgan would like to know more about the work Student ZM has been doing, hear about their goals, and discuss how their vision can support student voice and engagement across the district. Their goal for this meeting is to build a shared understanding before mapping out potential next steps together.

When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 1:30–2:30 PM (Central) Location: Sun Prairie West High School, 2850 Ironwood Dr, Sun Prairie, WI 53590 — West High School-1202 Conference Room Guests: Michael Morgan (organizer), Marlita Bevenue, Zackary Mark

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E-060 · Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Michael Morgan; Marlita Bevenue
Date	Oct 20, 2026, 2:50 PM
Attachments	SPASD_Student_Voice_Report_4.pdf

Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue,

Thank you both for taking the time to meet today. As promised, here's a short written summary so we all leave with the same notes. I've also attached a draft of my next public report (Student Advocacy Report #4), which is based on our conversation.

Before I publish it, I'd appreciate it if you could look it over and let me know if I misrepresented anything you said. If I don't hear back by Monday, October 26, I'll go ahead and post it.

Quick recap

Communication after serious incidents: What students are told depends on direct impact, the age of the students, and how serious the incident is. Immediate safety comes first. Then the communications office works with the principal and district leadership to confirm facts and decide what each audience needs to know. Names, individual consequences, student records, and personnel matters can't be shared. I noted in the report that Dr. Morgan's answers reflected his own understanding, not a formal district protocol.

What students asked for: short, factual messages even when names can't be shared, naming the specific law when something is off limits, and "you said, we did" updates so students see what happened with their input.

Newsletters: Thank you, Ms. Bevenue, for committing to send district newsletters to all students when they launch in November. That's exactly the kind of change I was hoping to see, and I've highlighted it in the report.

June 2027: We agreed the next step is to ask students across the district what good student voice looks and sounds like, then set goals and benchmarks from those answers. Dr. Morgan, I'm taking your feedback and expanding the survey to reach all three high schools, all four grade levels, and a more diverse range of students.

Weighted grades: This morning the student work group agreed weighting should start with next year's freshmen (Class of 2031) in 2027–28. It goes to the Teaching and Learning Committee on November 2 and the Board on November 9.

Still open

- Sharing the survey through district channels
- A staff partner for a pilot district student advisory council
- A recurring student–district check-in
- One public "you said, we did" update this semester

We ran out of time before the advisory council and equity questions, so I'd love to set up a follow-up meeting. Would sometime in the next few weeks work for you?

Links Climate survey: https://forms.gle/9ULwNASeJFceHkCy8 Website: https://spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app Instagram: @spasdstudentvoice

Thank you again, Zackary Mark

E-061 · Re: Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From	Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Michael Morgan
Date	Oct 21, 2026, 10:38 AM

Hi, Zachary.

Thanks so much for putting together this recap! I really enjoyed our conversation and appreciate the work you're doing to elevate student voices across the district. And yes, as we discussed, beginning in November, we'll also share our district family newsletters with scholars, in addition to parents and caregivers. I think this is a great step toward keeping students informed and connected. I don't have any additional feedback at this point, but Dr. Morgan may have some thoughts to share. Thanks again for your leadership, and I look forward to continuing the conversation!

With gratitude, Marlita A. Bevenue Director, Strategic Communications, Sun Prairie Area School District 501 S. Bird Street, Sun Prairie, WI 53590

E-062 · Student Voice Story

From	Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
To	Vientiane Yang (Multimedia & Website Specialist, SPASD); Zackary Mark
Date	Oct 21, 2026, 10:26 AM

Hi, Zachary and Vien.

I wanted to connect the two of you!

Zackary, thanks again for taking the time to meet with Dr. Morgan and me yesterday. I really appreciate the work you're doing to elevate student voices at Sun Prairie West and across the district. I think it's a great story to share with our school community!

Vien is our Multimedia Strategist and would love to connect with you for a brief interview about your student voice advocacy work, what inspired you to get involved, and what you hope to accomplish.

Zackary, could you coordinate a time for this Thursday with Vien that works with your schedule? I'll let you two take it from here! Thanks again, and I look forward to seeing this story come together!

With gratitude, Marlita A. Bevenue

E-063 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Zackary Mark
To Vientiane Yang
Date Oct 21, 2026, 11:19 AM

Hi Vien, it is a pleasure to meet you. I am free anytime between 12:40 and 3:50 tomorrow. It would be great to meet you then. If you'd like, I can coordinate with the SPW office to find a room for us to meet. I can't wait to meet you!

Best, Zackary Mark

E-064 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Vientiane Yang, Multimedia & Website Specialist, SPASD
To Zackary Mark
Date Oct 21, 2026

Hi Zackary,

It is nice to meet you! I'm excited for the interview. Let's aim for 1pm tomorrow if that works. If you can secure a room that would be great, feel free to loop me in if the admins or office staff are asking.

In addition to the interview, I'll also be taking your headshot. Just wanted to give you a heads-up!

Let me know if you have any questions.

Thanks, Vientiane Yang Multimedia & Website Specialist | (608) 834-6568 | 501 S. Bird Street, Sun Prairie, WI 53590 | Pronouns: He/His/Him

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E-065 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Zackary Mark
To Vientiane Yang
Date Oct 21, 2026

Room 1007, in the front office at 1:00 pm. Can't wait to meet you tomorrow!

Best, Zack

E-066 · Re: Student Voice Story

From Vientiane Yang
To Zackary Mark
Date Oct 21, 2026

Sounds great! See you tomorrow.

E-067 · Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent
Date	Oct 29, 2026, 7:31 PM
Attachments	One-page outline

Dear Dr. Reed,

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Zack Mark. I am a student at Sun Prairie West High School and the founder of SPASD Student Voice, a student-led effort focused on safety, communication, transparency and student voice across the district. Thank you for the time you have given to students this fall.

I am writing to formally propose a spring 2027 pilot of a district-wide Student Advisory Council. A one-page outline is attached for your review.

Background

Students have worked with the district on several issues this fall. The weighted grades work group, led by Dr. Mould, included students early, and the plan is scheduled for a Board committee preview on November 2 and a Board presentation on November 9. The district also committed on October 20 to a student newsletter, which was confirmed in writing on October 21.

These steps show what is possible when students are included early. However, there is currently no standing structure in which students from every school meet with district leadership on a regular schedule. A council would make that kind of collaboration routine and would give the district a reliable way to test plans with students before they are rolled out.

Proposal summary

- **Membership:** 12 to 16 students in grades 9 to 12: four to six each from East and West, and two from Prairie Phoenix Academy, chosen through an open application. At least one seat per school would go to a student not already in a leadership role.
- **Meetings:** monthly, 60 minutes, rotating between buildings, with transportation support for students who need it.
- **District role:** you or a designee would attend at least every other meeting, and one staff liaison would attend all meetings.
- **Accountability:** a public summary after each meeting and a report to the Board twice a year.

Proposed timeline

- November to December 2026: pilot approved and a staff liaison named
- January 2027: two-week application window at each high school
- February to May 2027: four monthly meetings
- May 2027: joint review to decide whether to continue in 2027-28

Requests

1. Approval of a spring 2027 pilot
2. Designation of a district staff liaison
3. A 20-minute meeting in November to plan the launch

I recognize that the Student Senate restart or another existing structure may be a better home for this work, and I would welcome your guidance on how the council could build on what is already in place. I am glad to adjust the proposal based on your feedback.

Thank you for your consideration. I look forward to hearing from you.

Respectfully,

Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School

E-068 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 9:00 AM

Hey Zackary, I love this idea. I will find time to connect with you on this after you run this by your principal. Invite me to join the conversation!

E-069 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Peggy Shoemaker, Sun Prairie West
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 10:52 AM

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

I hope you're doing well. Yesterday I sent Dr. Reed a proposal for a spring 2027 pilot of a district-wide Student Advisory Council, and he replied that he likes the idea and asked me to run it by you first. He'd like to be invited to join the conversation, so I've copied him here.

The short version of the proposal:

- 12 to 16 students in grades 9–12: four to six each from East and West, and two from Prairie Phoenix Academy, chosen through an open application, with at least one seat per school for a student not already in a leadership role
- Monthly 60-minute meetings from February to May 2027, rotating between buildings
- A district staff liaison at every meeting, and a public summary after each one
- A joint review in May to decide whether to continue

I also want to make sure it works alongside the Student Senate rather than competing with it, so I'd really value your thoughts on how the two could fit together.

Would you have 20–30 minutes in the next week or two to talk? I'm free during non-core class times on A and B days from 12:15 to 3:50 p.m. Dr. Reed, if any of those times work for you, I'd love for you to join.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-070 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Principal Peggy Shoemaker
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 11:51 AM

Zack,

Thank you for reaching out. I am uncertain about the purpose of this group. Our Student Senate is just beginning and we are working hard for West. I also know that the School Board has student representatives as well. What would you hope to accomplish with the Student Advisory Council? It seems as if it would be a duplication of efforts, at least at West,

Ms. Shoemaker

E-071 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Peggy Shoemaker
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 12:16 PM

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the quick reply and for being honest about your concerns. I agree the Student Senate is important, and I don't want to take anything away from what you're building at West. I'd like to explain a little more about what I have in mind, because I think it can support the Senate rather than compete with it.

What it would be: A small group of 12 to 16 high school students from East, West, and Prairie Phoenix that meets once a month with district leaders. It would only focus on district-wide decisions, things that affect every school, and it would share a short public summary after each meeting so other students know what was discussed and what happened.

Why it would exist: This fall, some of the biggest issues for students were district-level: weighted grades, how the district communicates with students after serious incidents, and the new student newsletter. Students were included in each of those, but it happened one case at a time, usually because a student or staff member reached out. The council would make that routine, so the district has a regular group of students from every school it can check plans with before they roll out, and students have a predictable way to hear back about what happened with their input.

How it's different:

- Student Senate: focuses on one school and works with the principal on building-level issues at West. The council wouldn't take on building issues. Anything specific to West would go to the Senate.
- Board student representatives: as I understand it, they represent students at Board meetings, once items are already on the agenda. The council would work earlier, while district plans are still being shaped, and could help the student representatives hear from more students before Board meetings. I'd like to learn more about how they're chosen so the two fit together.

- Work groups like weighted grades: focus on one issue for a set time. The council would be ongoing and could help find students for future work groups.

How it could avoid duplication at West: West's seats could come from the Student Senate, so the Senate stays the voice for West and the council simply connects it with students at the other schools. The Board's student representatives could also be members. If it fits better, it could even be a once-a-month meeting of existing student leaders from each school instead of a new group.

I'm very open to changing the proposal based on your feedback. Would you have 20 minutes to talk about it in the next week or two? Dr. Reed, I'd welcome your thoughts as well.

Thank you, Zack

E-072 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Principal Peggy Shoemaker
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 3:37 PM

Hi Zach, This sounds like more of a District Student group so I am going to opt out for now. We appreciate your ongoing support in working on the weighted grades issue.

Ms. Shoemaker

E-073 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Peggy Shoemaker; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Oct 30, 2026, 3:41 PM

Dear Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for taking the time to read it and for the kind words about the weighted grades work. I understand, and I appreciate you letting me know.

Dr. Reed, since Ms. Shoemaker sees this as a district-level group, I'd love to take you up on connecting about it. Would you have 20 minutes in the next couple of weeks to talk about next steps for a spring pilot, including who might serve as the district staff liaison? I'm free during non-core class times on A and B days from 12:15 to 3:50 p.m., and I'm happy to work around your schedule.

Thank you both, Zack Mark

E-074 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From Dr. Antoine Reed, Superintendent
To Zackary Mark; Karen Richmond
Date Nov 2, 2026, 12:31 PM

Hi Zackary, Karen, I know November may be tough, but is it a time I can get to Zachary to hear him out? If so, I can make it happen, even if it's before school starts.

E-075 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From Karen Richmond, Executive Assistant for the Superintendent and Board Leadership
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 2, 2026, 6:35 PM

Hi Zack,

Do you have availability to meet with Dr. Reed before school either this Wednesday, Nov 4th or next week Wednesday on Nov 11th?

Thanks, Karen

E-076 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From Zackary Mark
To Karen Richmond
Cc Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 2, 2026, 7:43 PM

Hi Ms. Richmond,

Thank you for reaching out and helping coordinate this.

I would be available to meet with Dr. Reed on either Wednesday, November 4 or Wednesday, November 11. My preference would be sometime between 7:30 and 8:00 a.m.

I'm happy to accommodate whichever date works best for Dr. Reed.

I appreciate the opportunity to discuss the proposal and explore the next steps for establishing a district-wide Student Advisory Council.

Thank you again!

Best, Zack Mark

E-077 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From Karen Richmond
To Zackary Mark
Cc Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 3, 2026, 11:36 AM

Hi Zack,

Dr. Reed would be able to meet you at SPW in the main office at 7:50am tomorrow morning. Would that work?

Thanks, Karen

E-078 · Re: Proposal for a District-Wide Student Advisory Council (Spring 2027 Pilot)

From Zackary Mark
To Karen Richmond
Cc Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 3, 2026, 1:59 PM

Hi Ms. Richmond,

Thank you for coordinating this!

Yes, 7:50 a.m. tomorrow morning at Sun Prairie West works perfectly for me.

Please extend my thanks to Dr. Reed as well. I appreciate him taking the time to meet with me and hear more about the proposed District-Wide Student Advisory Council.

I look forward to discussing the proposal, potential next steps for the Spring 2027 pilot, and how we can establish a meaningful, sustainable structure for student voice across the district.

Thank you again for your help!

Best, Zack Mark

E-079 · Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Zackary Mark
To Principal Jim Ertel, Sun Prairie East (also sent to Sarah Dianich, Sun Prairie East, at 10:59 AM)
Date Nov 3, 2026, 10:20 AM

Dear Mr. Ertel,

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Zack Mark. I am a student at Sun Prairie West High School and the founder of SPASD Student Voice, a student-led effort that brings student feedback on safety, communication, transparency, and fairness to district leaders.

Background. This fall, Student Voice has:

- Participated in the district's weighted grades work group, whose plan goes to the Board of Education on November 9

- Secured a district commitment, confirmed in writing on October 21, to publish a student newsletter
- Launched a public website and regular progress reports (spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app)
- Proposed a district-wide Student Advisory Council to Dr. Reed for spring 2027

Why I am writing. So far, most student participation has come from one school. For student input to represent the whole district, it needs to include students from Sun Prairie East.

Request. Would you be willing to help in one of the following ways?

1. Connect me with a staff member, such as a student council or club advisor, who could share the opportunity with interested students
2. Share a brief invitation with East students (I would send it to you for approval first)
3. Advise me on the best way to reach East students

If the Student Advisory Council moves forward, East would hold four to six seats, and I would like interested students to be aware of it early.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully, Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School; Founder, SPASD Student Voice

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E-080 · Request for Assistance: Including Prairie Phoenix Academy Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Nehemirah Barrett, Prairie Phoenix Academy
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 10:20 AM

Dear Mr. Barrett,

(Same introduction and background as the Sun Prairie East letter.)

Why I am writing. Prairie Phoenix Academy students have a perspective that is often missing from district conversations, and I want to make sure it is included. The Student Advisory Council proposal reserves two seats for Prairie Phoenix students.

Request. Would you be willing to help in one of the following ways?

1. Connect me with a staff member who could share the opportunity with interested students
2. Share a brief invitation with your students (I would send it to you for approval first)
3. Advise me on meeting times, locations or transportation needs that would make participation realistic for Prairie Phoenix students

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully, Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School; Founder, SPASD Student Voice

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E-081 · Request for Guidance: Including Prairie View Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Michelle Jensen, Prairie View Middle School (the same letter went to Shawn Bartelt at Patrick Marsh and Mark Roth at Central Heights)
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 10:20 AM

Dear Ms. Jensen,

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Zack Mark. I am a student at Sun Prairie West High School and the founder of SPASD Student Voice, a student-led effort that brings student feedback on safety, communication, transparency, and fairness to district leaders.

Background. This fall, Student Voice has participated in the district's weighted grades work group, secured a district commitment to publish a student newsletter, launched a public website with regular progress reports (spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app), and proposed a district-wide Student Advisory Council to Dr. Reed for spring 2027.

Why I am writing. Many district decisions affect middle school students as much as high school students, and I would like Prairie View students' perspectives to be heard, particularly from 8th graders preparing for high school.

Request. Because these are middle school students, I would only reach out through channels that you and your staff approve. Would you be willing to help in one of the following ways?

1. Connect me with a staff member, such as a student council advisor, who could gather student input or share the opportunity
2. Share a brief invitation or survey with students (I would send it to you for approval first)
3. Advise me on the best way to include Prairie View students

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully, Zack Mark — Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School; Founder, SPASD Student Voice

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E-082 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Prairie View Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Principal Michelle Jensen, Prairie View Middle School
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 3, 2026, 3:53 PM

Thanks, Zach.

Which topic/topics are you primarily looking for feedback from them?

E-083 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Prairie View Students in SPASD Student Voice

From Zackary Mark

To Principal Michelle Jensen

Date Nov 3, 2026, 3:55 PM

Hi Ms. Jensen,

Thank you for getting back to me!

I'm primarily interested in gathering student perspectives on a few district-wide topics:

1. Student Safety & Communication: How students receive information following significant school incidents and whether they feel informed and supported.
2. Student Voice & Representation: How middle school students feel their perspectives are included in district decisions and what opportunities they'd like to have to participate.
3. Transition to High School: Particularly for 8th graders, what questions, concerns, and priorities they have as they prepare to enter high school.
4. District Communication: How effectively the district communicates announcements, policy changes, and important information to students.

I would especially value feedback from 8th graders because they are preparing to transition into high school and can offer a perspective that isn't always represented in district-level conversations.

I'm not looking to create additional responsibilities for your staff. I'd be happy to provide a short, district-approved survey or work with an existing student leadership group if that would be easier.

Thank you again for your willingness to help. I appreciate the opportunity to make sure Prairie View students have a voice in these conversations.

Best, Zack Mark

The District-Wide Student Council (from November 4)

After the November 4 morning meeting with Dr. Reed, the proposal grew from a high school advisory council into a District-Wide Student Council: 3–5 representatives from every middle and high school, grades 6–12, meeting with district leaders and Dr. Reed. At noon that day, invitations went to every middle and high school principal, each copied to Dr. Reed. What was said at the meeting itself is not recorded here.

E-084 · Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Prairie Phoenix Academy

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Nehemirah Barrett, Prairie Phoenix Academy
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 4, 2026, 12:00 PM

Dear Mr. Barrett,

I am reaching out to invite Prairie Phoenix Academy to participate in the development of a District-Wide Student Council for the Sun Prairie Area School District.

The proposed council would bring together approximately 3–5 representatives from each middle and high school, with student representation across grades 6–12. I want the council to reflect the full range of student experiences in SPASD, including students whose educational paths and school experiences may look different from those at a traditional comprehensive middle or high school.

Prairie Phoenix Academy's emphasis on building relationships, creating belonging, maintaining high expectations, communication, and accountability is especially relevant to this effort. Those ideas should be reflected in a council that gives students from different educational settings a genuine opportunity to shape district conversations.

I would appreciate your help identifying 3–5 students enrolled at Prairie Phoenix Academy who may be interested in representing their peers. I would want the selection process to be flexible and accessible, recognizing that students may have different schedules, responsibilities, and experiences.

The council's proposed areas of focus include student mental health and well-being, engagement and belonging, academic experiences, district events, family and community engagement, and student recommendations to district leadership.

Would you be available for a brief phone call or meeting to discuss how Prairie Phoenix Academy could participate and what structure would work best for your students? I would also appreciate your recommendation for a staff point of contact who could help coordinate participation.

Thank you for considering this. It is important that a districtwide student council represents more than the largest or most traditional school communities. Prairie Phoenix Academy students should have a meaningful voice in the work as well.

Best, Zackary Mark Student Voice | District-Wide Student Council Initiative

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The same invitation, adapted to each school, went at the same time to Sun Prairie East (Principal Jim Ertel and Sarah Dianich), Sun Prairie West (Principal Peggy Shoemaker), Prairie View (Principal Michelle Jensen), Patrick Marsh (Principal Shawn Bartelt) and Central Heights (Mark Roth), all copied to Dr. Reed. Each letter tied the council to that school's own priorities, for example West's AVID, Developmental Designs and restorative practices, and Patrick Marsh's family engagement plan with its School Community Organization. Each asked for 3–5 student representatives (not only students already in leadership roles) and a staff point of contact.

E-085 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Patrick Marsh

From Principal Shawn Bartelt, Patrick Marsh Middle School
To Zackary Mark; Tiffany Kvalheim, school counselor
Cc Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 5, 2026, 9:01 AM

Good morning Zackary,

I think this is a wonderful idea! Creating opportunities for students to connect across buildings while developing their leadership skills is a great way to build relationships and strengthen our school community.

I'm including our school counselor, Mrs. Kvalheim, in this email, as she can help identify students who may be a good fit. She works closely with our Peer Ambassadors student group, and I envision 3–5 students from that group participating in this opportunity.

Is there a time next week that would work for you to connect virtually and discuss the next steps?

Enjoy your day!

E-086 · Re: District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie West Participation and Staff Sponsor

From Principal Peggy Shoemaker, Sun Prairie West
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 5, 2026, 9:29 AM

Hello Zach, Perhaps a good starting point would be to go to Student Council to find student representation for your club. If you are looking for a faculty advisor, I suggest making sure you are registering with the ATHLETIC/ACTIVITIES as a club. Feel free to reach out to any faculty member from West who might be interested.

Ms, Shoemaker

E-087 · Re: District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie West Participation and Staff Sponsor

From Zackary Mark
To Principal Peggy Shoemaker
Cc Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 5, 2026, 9:57 AM

Hi Ms. Shoemaker,

Thank you for the direction. I'll reach out to West's Student Council to find interested students and connect with the Athletics/Activities office about registering.

One quick question so I go through the right process: since the council would include students from every middle and high school and meet with Dr. Reed, should it still be registered as a West club, or is there a different path for a district-level group? Either way, I'll follow whatever process works best.

I'll also reach out to West staff who might be interested in serving as a sponsor.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-088 · Registering a new student group: District-Wide Student Council

From	Zackary Mark
To	Eric Nee, Sun Prairie West
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 10:03 AM

Hi Mr. Nee,

My name is Zack Mark, and I'm a student at West. Ms. Shoemaker suggested I reach out to you about registering a new student group.

I'm starting a District-Wide Student Council for Sun Prairie. It would include 3–5 students from each middle and high school who meet regularly with district leaders and Superintendent Dr. Reed to share student input. Patrick Marsh has already agreed to take part, and I'm reaching out to the other schools now.

Could you help me with a few questions?

1. Is there a form or application I need to fill out to register?
2. What do you need from a staff sponsor?
3. Since the group includes students from other schools, is there anything different about registering it at West?
4. Do you have any suggestions for a West staff member who might have room to sponsor a new group? I know a lot of teachers are already busy with other activities, so I'd appreciate your recommendation. I'd handle the planning and communication myself, so the sponsor role should be fairly light.

I'm happy to stop by your office or meet whenever works best for you.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-089 · Could I share a District-Wide Student Council opportunity at your next meeting?

From	Zackary Mark
To	Gavin Christianson, Student Council adviser, Sun Prairie West
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 10:06 AM

Hi Mr. Christianson,

My name is Zack Mark, and I'm a student at West. Ms. Shoemaker suggested I connect with Student Council about a new district-wide opportunity.

I'm starting a District-Wide Student Council for Sun Prairie. It would bring together 3–5 students from each middle and high school to meet regularly with district leaders and Superintendent Dr. Reed. Topics would include student well-being, belonging, academics, activities and other districtwide issues. It's meant to work alongside Student Council and Student Senate, not replace them, and give West students a voice at the district level too.

I'm looking for 3–5 West students across grades 9–12 who'd be interested, and I'd also love any members who want to help spread the word.

Would it be okay if I came to your next meeting for about 5 minutes to explain it and answer questions? If that doesn't work, I'm happy to send a short flyer you could share with members instead.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-090 · Re: District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie West Participation and Staff Sponsor

From Principal Peggy Shoemaker
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 5, 2026, 12:08 PM

I definitely see what you mean. Since this is a District club, I really don't know what your next step would be....I think the West Athletics would not be the right move then,,,

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E-091 · District-Wide Student Council | Question on Registering a District-Level Group

From Zackary Mark
To Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 5, 2026, 12:49 PM

Dear Dr. Reed,

I hope you're doing well. I'm following up on the District-Wide Student Council.

Ms. Shoemaker gave me some helpful direction. She suggested starting with West's Student Council to find student representatives and said that, for a faculty advisor, clubs usually register through the Athletics/Activities office.

When I asked whether that would still apply since the council would include students from every middle and high school, she agreed that it is a district group, so registering through West Athletics probably would not be the right fit. Neither of us was sure what the correct next step would be.

Could you point me toward the right process for setting up a district-level student group? Specifically:

- Who should the council register with, if not an individual school's Activities office?
- Should the staff sponsor come from one school, the district office, or should each school have its own point of contact?

I'm still planning to connect with West's Student Council and reach out to staff who might be interested, so I can keep things moving while we figure out the official path.

Thank you for your time and support.

Best, Zackary Mark

E-092 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Prairie Phoenix Academy

From	Principal Nehemirah Barrett, Prairie Phoenix Academy
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 5, 2026, 4:47 PM

Hi Zack,

I apologize for the delayed response. It has been a busy week, but I wanted to make sure I responded to your message.

First, I want to commend you for taking the initiative to advocate for student voice across our district. It is great to see students stepping into leadership roles and creating opportunities for their peers to be heard.

I appreciate you being intentional about including Prairie Phoenix Academy in this work. Our students bring valuable perspectives and experiences, and I agree that their voices should be represented in districtwide conversations.

I am supportive of this initiative and would be interested in learning more as the planning moves forward. As the structure and expectations for the council become clearer, we can explore how Prairie Phoenix students can meaningfully participate.

Thank you again for your leadership and for thinking of our students. Keep up the great work!

Best, Mr. Barrett

The Board's student representatives

E-093 · Question about the Board's student representatives

From	Zackary Mark
To	Karen Richmond, Executive Assistant for the Superintendent and Board Leadership
Date	Nov 4, 2026, 12:00 PM

Hi Ms. Richmond,

I hope you're doing well. Students have been asking about the School Board's student representatives, and I want to make sure I share accurate information.

The district website says the Board appoints two non-voting student members who serve one-year terms. Could you help me with two questions?

1. How are the student representatives chosen, and when does the application open each year?
2. What's the best way for students to share ideas or concerns with them?

I'll share your answer with students word for word through SPASD Student Voice. Thank you for your help.

Best, Zack Mark

E-094 · Re: Question about the Board's student representatives

From Karen Richmond
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 5, 2026, 11:52 AM

Hi Zack,

Thank you for reaching out with your questions. Student representatives actually serve a two-year term, taking office at the end of their sophomore year and serving through the end of their senior year. The recruitment process for new junior representatives usually gets underway in December, and applications generally open in mid-January for current sophomores. The School Board Member Selection Committee will interview candidates and vote on a candidate for each open seat, typically prior to Spring Break. I'm including the link to Board Procedure 3: Student Representatives to the School Board, which may help in answering any other questions you might have.

Students are always welcome to reach out to the student representatives at any time; the current SPW reps are [two students, names removed in this record]. The student representatives have been discussing ways to be more visible at their schools, feel free to connect with them to get more details.

Please let me know if you have any other questions.

Thanks! Karen

Follow-ups (November 4–6)

E-095 · Thank you, and next steps on the student council pilot

From Zackary Mark
To Dr. Antoine Reed
Cc Karen Richmond
Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Dear Dr. Reed,

Thank you for meeting with me before school on November 4. I appreciated you taking the time to hear about the student council pilot.

Here's what I understood as our next steps:

- Email Administration at SPE, SPW, PPA, PMMS, PVMS, & CHMS
- Develop Pilot Program for a District Student Council
- Create a schedule and calendar with ideas for talking points

Please let me know if I missed anything. With your permission, I'd like to share a short summary on SPASD Student Voice, so students know where things stand.

Thank you again, Zack Mark

E-096 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Sun Prairie East

From Sarah Dianich, LT Principal Substitute, Sun Prairie East
To Zackary Mark
Cc Principal Jim Ertel; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date Nov 6, 2026, 3:13 PM

Good afternoon, Zackary -

Apologies for the delay. I truly appreciate your advocacy. Just to confirm, the Student Voice group has been approved as a district/school sponsored activity, correct? If so, I can:

1. Connect you with a staff member - once we have your invitation, we can ask our student council advisors to share it.
2. Share a brief invitation with East students - I could put this in our weekly newsletter.
3. Advise you on the best way to reach East students - I would say that a clear, concise invitation (slide, poster) that we could share in SP30 might be the most effective way to reach East students.

Have a great weekend.

E-097 · Re: Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr., Director of Systemic Equity and Inclusion
To Marlita Bevenue
Cc Zackary Mark
Date Nov 4, 2026, 11:44 AM

Good morning Zachary,

I'm a little late to the conversation, but I want to echo Marlita's sentiments. I appreciate your leadership, thoughtfulness, and commitment to elevating student voice across our district. Thank you for taking the time to meet with us and for your continued advocacy on behalf of your peers.

I look forward to continuing our conversations and exploring opportunities to strengthen student voice and engagement across our system. Dr. Morgan

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E-098 · Re: Recap and draft public report: Student Voice & District Engagement, Oct 20

From Zackary Mark
To Dr. Michael Morgan; Marlita Bevenue
Date Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Dr. Morgan,

Thank you for the kind words, and thank you again to both of you for meeting with me in October.

I'd like to set up the follow-up meeting we talked about so we can cover the items we ran out of time for: the pilot student advisory council and a staff partner for it, sharing the student survey

through district channels, a recurring student-district check-in, and one "you said, we did" update this semester.

Would any time in the next two to three weeks work for you both? I'm generally free before 8 AM or after school, and I'm happy to work around your schedules.

Ms. Bevenue, I'm also looking forward to the first district newsletter going out to students this month.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-099 · An idea for the student newsletter: Board agendas in plain language

From	Zackary Mark
To	Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Hi Ms. Bevenue,

Thank you again for opening the district newsletters to students. One idea for a recurring piece: a two- or three-sentence, plain-language summary of what's on the next Board agenda that affects students, with a link to the full agenda and how to sign up for public comment.

Students often don't know a decision is coming until it's already made. A short heads-up would help, and I'd be happy to help draft or review the first few if that's useful.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-100 · Two ideas for hearing from students

From	Zackary Mark
To	Board President Diana McFarland
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Dear President McFarland,

Thank you for the Board's openness to students this year, from the Act 95 hearing in January to the weighted grades presentation on November 9. I have two ideas I'd like to ask about.

First, would the Board consider a short, recurring student update on regular meeting agendas, for example, five minutes once a month? It could be given by the Board's student representatives, with input gathered from students at every high school. It would give the Board a steady read on what students are seeing before decisions reach a vote, and give students a predictable way to be heard.

Second, students often ask what Board members actually do. Would you, or another Board member, be willing to answer five short written questions for SPASD Student Voice? I'd post the answers word for word.

1. What does a typical week look like for a Board member?
2. What's the hardest kind of decision the Board makes?
3. How do student comments change your thinking?
4. What do you wish students knew about the Board?
5. What's the best way for a student to reach the Board?

I'd be glad to talk about either idea. Thank you for considering them.

Respectfully, Zack Mark

E-101 · Could you check two student guides for accuracy?

From	Zackary Mark
To	Keith Medema
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Hi Mr. Medema,

I made two short guides on the SPASD Student Voice site for students: an Act 95 checklist ("I might be top 10%, now what?") and an AP vs. dual credit vs. capstone chart. Before more students use them, would you be willing to check them for accuracy? Both are on the Learn tab at spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app. Any corrections are welcome.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-102 · A 30-minute lesson on a real SPASD decision

From	Zackary Mark
To	Caryn Peters
Date	Nov 6, 2026, 1:30 PM

Hi,

Would you be interested in a 30-minute class activity on a real district decision? Students would learn how weighted grades move from a work group to a Board vote (10 minutes), play the "You're on the Board" simulation (10 minutes), and write optional comments to the Board (10 minutes). Everything is on the Learn tab of spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app. I'm happy to lead it or just share materials.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-103 · Re: Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Sarah Dianich, Sun Prairie East
Cc	Principal Jim Ertel; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 8, 2026, 2:43 PM
Attachments	SP30 slide and poster

Hi Ms. Dianich,

Thank you for getting back to me, and for the ideas on reaching East students.

To answer your question directly: not yet. The council isn't formally approved as a district or school sponsored activity. When I met with Dr. Reed on November 4, he asked me to reach out to each school's administration and build a pilot plan, which is the step I'm on now. I've kept him copied so he can correct anything I've missed.

I made the slide and poster you suggested for SP30 and attached both. They describe it as a student-led pilot and ask interested students to email me. I'm happy to change anything, or to hold them until the pilot is approved if you'd prefer to wait.

When the time is right, I'd be grateful if your student council advisors could pass it along.

Thank you, Zack Mark

E-104 · A free way for local businesses to support student voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Sun Prairie Area Chamber of Commerce
Date	Nov 9, 2026, 8:00 AM

Hello,

My name is Zack Mark, and I'm a student in the Sun Prairie Area School District. I run SPASD Student Voice, a student-led project that helps students and families ask the district questions and see the answers.

I'm looking for local businesses willing to put a small counter card by their register for a month. It has a QR code, and the slogan is "Your school. Your say." There's no cost, and we'd thank each business on our Instagram.

Would the Chamber be willing to share this with members in a newsletter, or point me to a few businesses that might be interested? I'm happy to send the card design or stop by the office.

Thank you, Zack Mark

Follow-ups (November 7–10)

E-105 · Questions about the superintendent licensing situation

From	Zackary Mark
To	President Diana McFarland and members of the Board of Education
Date	Nov 7, 2026, 7:00 AM

Dear President McFarland and members of the Board,

My name is Zack Mark, and I run SPASD Student Voice. I'm writing about the WMTV 15 report on Dr. Reed's Wisconsin superintendent license.

According to that report, DPI denied Dr. Reed's application on October 7, and DPI says it told Dr. Reed and President McFarland in August that he wasn't eligible. The report also says his contract requires a valid Wisconsin license at all times.

I'm not writing to attack Dr. Reed. Licensing rules for out-of-state hires are complicated, and I've appreciated his openness to working with students. But students and families learned about this from a news report. That's the part I think the board needs to address.

I'd like to ask the board to answer these questions publicly:

1. When did the full board learn that Dr. Reed was not eligible for a Wisconsin license?
2. Why wasn't this shared with the public before the October 26 meeting?
3. Who is currently authorized to carry out the duties that require a licensed superintendent?

4. Does the board plan to enforce, waive, or renegotiate the licensing requirement in the contract?
5. What is the realistic timeline for Dr. Reed to become fully licensed, and what happens if that doesn't work out?

Clear answers to these would go a long way toward rebuilding trust. I'm happy to talk with any of you about this, and I plan to share the board's response with students through SPASD Student Voice.

Thank you for your time.

Zack Mark

E-106 · Re: Could you check two student guides for accuracy?

From Keith Medema, School Counselor, Sun Prairie West
To Zackary Mark
Date Nov 9, 2026, 2:10 PM

Hi Zack, As you know we are still waiting for some final decisions regarding weighted grades. The other items look accurate. Once we learn more details regarding the weighted grades, please schedule a time to meet with me so that we can review the items to ensure that everything is correct. Thanks, Mr. Medema

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E-107 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Central Heights

From Principal Mark Roth, Central Heights Middle School
To Zackary Mark
Cc Jennifer Loranger
Date Nov 10, 2026, 7:05 AM

Hello Zackary,

Thank you for the information. Central Heights has a Student Council that meets regularly with our building leaders to share their student voice within our building. As you describe a district wide organization, I think it would be best to start with our current building group of leaders. Jen Loranger is our staff member that leads our Student Council. Could you reach out to her to begin this process?

E-108 · Re: Invitation to Help Establish a District-Wide Student Council | Central Heights

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Mark Roth; Jennifer Loranger
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 10, 2026, 10:59 AM

Hi Mr. Roth,

Thank you for getting back to me and for connecting me with Ms. Loranger. Starting with your current Student Council makes a lot of sense.

Hi Ms. Loranger,

It's nice to meet you. I'm working on a District-Wide Student Council that would bring together a few student representatives from each middle and high school to share feedback with district leaders. Since your Student Council already meets with building leaders, it seems like a natural fit for Central Heights.

Would you have 15 to 20 minutes for a quick call, Google Meet, or in-person meeting in the next week or two? I can walk you through how the council would work and answer any questions. I'm usually free after school, but I'm happy to work around your schedule.

Thank you both, Zack Mark

E-109 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Patrick Marsh Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Principal Shawn Bartelt, Patrick Marsh
To	Zackary Mark
Date	Nov 9, 2026, 12:48 PM

Good afternoon,

3pm on Thursday works best for Mrs. Kvalheim and me. Would you want to connect virtually or come to Patrick Marsh to meet with us?

We are looking forward to connecting with you!

Mr. Bartelt

E-110 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Patrick Marsh Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Zackary Mark
To	Principal Shawn Bartelt; Tiffany Kvalheim
Cc	Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 10, 2026, 11:03 AM

Good morning,

3pm on Thursday works great for me as well. Could we meet in person at Patrick Marsh? Thank you & I can't wait to meet you both!

Best, Zack Mark

E-111 · Re: Request for Guidance: Including Patrick Marsh Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Tiffany Kvalheim, School Counselor, Patrick Marsh
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Principal Shawn Bartelt; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 10, 2026, 11:18 AM

Hi Zack,

We look forward to meeting you as well. I sent us a calendar invite. With it being the end of the day here, cars will be lining up in our main driveway. I would recommend entering the staff driveway off of Stone Quarry Rd and parking in any space that is available. We will meet you in the front office. Thank you, Tiffany

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E-112 · Re: Request for Assistance: Including Sun Prairie East Students in SPASD Student Voice

From	Sarah Dianich, LT Principal Substitute, Sun Prairie East
To	Zackary Mark
Cc	Principal Jim Ertel; Dr. Antoine Reed
Date	Nov 10, 2026, 12:23 PM

Thank you for your response, Zackary -

Unfortunately, I cannot share this with students until this is a school-sponsored program. Do you have a timeline for that?

October 20 Meeting: Pre-Read & Discussion Guide

Prepared by Zackary, October 15, 2026. An independent, student-led summary for discussion, not an official SPASD document.

Meeting at a glance

This meeting's aim is shared: agree on one or two concrete next steps that make student voice a regular, documented part of how SPASD listens and decides.

- When: Tuesday, October 20, 2026, 1:30–2:30 PM
- Where: Sun Prairie West High School, Room 1202
- Who: Dr. Michael Morgan, Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion · Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications · Zackary Mark, Student Advocate, SPWHS
- Coordinated by: Carolyn Pao

Agenda

- 1:30 — Welcome, purpose, and how we'll keep notes
- 1:35 — Work since January: what's moved and what's still open
- 1:50 — Goals and vision, including a District Student Advisory Council
- 2:05 — Building a district-wide student group
- 2:15 — Next steps: owners and dates

Work since January

Since January 2026, student input has helped produce a Student Senate at West, student seats in two leadership searches, and an active weighted grades policy effort.

- Oct 1 — Title IX changes and LGBTQIA+ protections, with Dr. Tricia Rodey: district protections confirmed unchanged; reporting through Speak Up Speak Out being strengthened; idea raised for a student-friendly know-your-rights resource.
- Aug 27 — Student voice, leadership, climate and Senate follow-up, with Dr. Taren Turner and Janet Thomas: discussion of lasting structures for student–district collaboration.
- Aug 18 — How the district budget is built, with Matt Clark: shared understanding of the five-year forecast, staffing costs and fund balance.
- August — Student voice under new leadership, with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed: discussed a district-wide Student Advisory Council that lasts through leadership changes.
- Apr 27 — Student Senate election at SPWHS: 9 senators elected, 3 per rising grade.
- Apr 13 — Superintendent finalist session: students questioned every candidate.
- Apr 3 & 7 — SPWHS principal interviews: students served on the interview panel.
- Mar 2 — Student advocacy meeting, with Dr. Sarah Chaja-Clardy, Principal Peggy Shoemaker and staff: student seats in the principal search; Senate planning; clearer mandated-reporting info for students.
- Feb 26 – now — Weighted grades work group, with Dr. Curtis Mould, students and staff: consensus on a 5.0 scale; caregiver survey finalized; Board first reading targeted for early November.

- Jan 26 — Act 95 public hearing, Board of Education: 31 students presented survey findings and a recommendation.
- Jan 13 — Student Safety, Trust & a Proposed Framework, Board of Education: Board response Jan 20; led to the meetings above.

The same transparency questions have also been raised with the city, through meetings with Police Chief Kevin Warych on license plate reader cameras.

What students have said

Most students in early outreach said they feel physically safe at school; the gap is trust that adults will follow through when they speak up.

- Safety and communication: after serious incidents, students often learn what happened from rumors or social media first.
- Consistency and accountability: discipline and follow-up can feel different from one building to the next.
- Voice and follow-through: students feel heard symbolically rather than systemically, and rarely learn what their input changed.

> "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen." — a student, winter 2026

These early responses were voluntary and not a statistical sample. The bilingual climate survey (12 questions, English and Spanish, open to students, families, staff and community) is meant to fill that gap; results to date will be shared at the meeting.

- 31 students: Act 95 group that presented at the January 26 Board hearing (Act 95 group materials)
- 38%: high schoolers in a district survey interested in weighting all classes (SPASD weighted grades staff survey)
- 9 senators: elected at SPWHS in April 2026, 3 from each rising grade (April 2026 progress report)
- 5% / 10%: Act 95 class-rank cutoffs for guaranteed UW–Madison / other UW admission (2023 Wisconsin Act 95)
- 3 reports: public reports on student safety, voice and progress, February to spring 2026

Survey link: forms.gle/9ULwNASeJFceHkCy8

The proposal: a District Student Advisory Council pilot

The proposal is a one-semester pilot of a small, district-wide student council with a staff partner, reviewed before it expands. Every detail below is a starting point for discussion.

- Members: students from Prairie View, Patrick Marsh and Central Heights middle schools, East, West and Prairie Phoenix Academy, across grades and backgrounds
- Selection: a short application plus a fair draw, so it reaches beyond the students who are already involved
- Staff partner: one named district staff member who keeps records and follow-through, without directing recommendations

- Meetings: regular, on a set calendar with district leadership; agendas posted 24–48 hours ahead, minutes within 72 hours
- Role: advisory; consulted on major student-facing changes before they are final
- Relationship to existing groups: works alongside the SPW Student Senate and the student Board representatives, not in place of them
- Pilot length: one semester, then a review of what worked

How a student concern would become action:

1. Students raise an issue through the survey, a Senate, a club or a council member.
2. The council gathers input from more schools and documents it.
3. A written recommendation goes to district leadership.
4. The district responds in writing: yes, no, or not yet, and why.
5. A short public update tells students what changed, what didn't, and why.

Where each office could fit:

- Strategic Communications: student-facing messages after serious incidents, channels that reach students, and a home for public updates (step 5).
- Systemic Equity & Inclusion: a membership that reaches students who are usually underrepresented, Spanish-language access, and climate and belonging across buildings.

Discussion questions

Starred ones are the priority if time runs short.

Where we agree on the goal

- ★ If student voice in SPASD is working well by June 2027, what would each of us see that we don't see today?
- Has a student ever changed a district decision this year? If so, how did students find out?
- Which district goals this year could students help with most?

Communication (Strategic Communications)

- ★ After a serious incident, how is it decided what students are told, how fast, and by whom? What legally can't be shared, and how can we explain those limits to students?
- Which channels does the district know actually reach students, and how is that measured?
- What would a twice-a-year "you said, we did" update need in order to be realistic: who writes it, where it lives, and who approves it?

Equity and inclusion (Systemic Equity & Inclusion)

- ★ Which student groups are hardest for the district to hear from today, and what has worked when you have reached them?
- How should council members be chosen so it isn't the same small group of already-involved students?
- What existing focus groups, affinity groups or listening sessions could a council build on instead of starting from scratch?

Making a student group last

- ★ Which office or role is the right long-term home for a district student council?

- What upcoming decisions this year could get student input before they are final?
- What would make this pilot worth continuing after one semester, and what would tell us to change course?
- How should a council connect with the SPW Student Senate, the student Board representatives, and the superintendent?

Commitments

- ★ What is one thing each of us will do in the next 30 days?
- Who owns follow-up, and when do we meet next?

Next steps (owners and dates to be filled in at the meeting)

- Share the climate survey through district channels
- Name a staff partner for a pilot advisory council
- Set a recurring student–district check-in
- Publish one "you said, we did" update this semester
- Other steps agreed in the meeting

A written recap will follow within two school days.

October 20 Meeting: Slides

21-slide deck for the October 20 meeting (an earlier 16-slide draft had the same content). Slides that repeat the pre-read are not repeated here.

Questions to ask at the start: Is it OK if I record or take notes? Can you help share the survey? May I leave a handout with you? Can we set future meetings?

Where it started: the Student Safety & Trust Framework (January 13, 2026)

- Acknowledge & communicate: tell students when serious incidents happen, even when details can't be shared.
- Explain safety & reporting: one clear, district-wide overview of how concerns are reported and resolved.
- Consistent protocols: the same conduct and safety standards in every SPASD building.
- Stronger student voice: formal advisory structures with a required response from administration.
- Proactive wellness: advisory time, manageable counselor caseloads, clear paths to help.
- Review & reflect: regular climate surveys and public reporting on progress.

Ten months of conversations

Jan 13 Safety & Trust Framework (Board) · Jan 26 Act 95 hearing (Board of Education) · Feb–now weighted GPA group (Dr. Mould) · Mar 2 advocacy meeting (Student Senate) · Apr 3 & 7 principal interviews (student panel) · Apr 13 superintendent finalists · May 5 2024 concerns (Nicholas Reichhoff) · Jul 10 ALPR cameras (Chief Warych) · August Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed · Aug 18 district budget (Matt Clark) · Aug 27 voice & mental health (Dr. Turner) · Sep 25 ALPR follow-up, Flock to Axon · Oct 1 Title IX & LGBTQIA+ (Dr. Rodey) · Oct 7 Public Safety Committee (City Hall)

What has already moved

- Done: Student Senate launched at SPWHS for 2026–27, seeded by the Act 95 groups
- Done: students interviewed principal candidates and met superintendent finalists
- Done: LGBTQIA+ protections confirmed in writing after the federal Title IX change
- In progress: weighted grades policy, criteria now, Board first reading targeted for November
- In progress: faster review of reports through changes to Speak Up Speak Out

The gaps that remain

- Student-facing incident messaging: students still hear about serious incidents through rumors and social media first.
- Reporting, explained for students: when reports escalate, when families are told, and what students can expect.

- Voice beyond one building: the Senate covers West. Middle schoolers, East and PPA students need a regular path in, too.
- Closing the loop: students rarely hear back on what changed, what didn't, and why.

Status from Student Advocacy Report #2: communication improvements "in development," system-level implementation "pending."

Five goals for 2026–27

1. Field the climate survey district-wide and share the results publicly
2. Pilot a District Student Advisory Council with middle and high schools
3. Set regular student–district meetings on a calendar, not by request
4. Back the Student Senate's first action plan, including weighted grades
5. Publish "you said, we did" updates so students see where input went

The council idea was discussed with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed in August as a way to make student voice "a consistent part of SPASD rather than something that changes with leadership transitions." The council would have a written charter and a staff owner, so it survives any one superintendent or student. Step 5 of the process, the public update, "is the one students almost never see today, and it's the one that builds trust."

Where the two offices fit, as listed on the slides: Strategic Communications helps students understand the why, not just the what (messages after serious incidents, channels that reach students, a home for "you said, we did" updates, getting the survey to every family). Systemic Equity & Inclusion helps make sure every student has a way in, not the same few (seats for PPA and underrepresented groups, Spanish-language access from day one, climate and belonging across buildings, a student-built know-your-rights guide).

The climate feedback survey

Open to students, families, staff and community members. 12 questions in English and Spanish. Results shared only in aggregate. Four focus areas, set in meetings with district leaders: a Student Senate or advisory structure; student involvement in leadership decisions; communication and transparency on safety, policy and services; trust and consistency across schools.

Sample questions: Do students have a meaningful voice in district decisions? Rate communication to students about important issues, 1 to 5. Should students have a role in choosing principals or superintendents?

The pieces already exist

- SPW Student Senate: 9 elected senators building their first action plan
- Act 95 & weighted grades students: East and West students already working with district staff
- SPASD Student Voice: the survey, public reports and @spasdstudentvoice
- Missing link: one district-level table where they meet, plus middle schoolers and PPA, with a staff owner who keeps it going.

Closing slide: "Student voice should move beyond being heard to being meaningfully connected to action."

October 20 Meeting: Pamphlet & Handout

Tri-fold pamphlet (outside and inside) and the one-page meeting handout.



Pamphlet, outside

01 · WHERE WE'VE BEEN

FROM ONE EMAIL TO A SEAT AT THE TABLE

Jan	Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board; Act 95 students present at a public hearing
Feb	Weighted grades work group starts with district staff
Mar	Student advocacy meeting with school and district leaders
Apr	Students interview principal candidates, meet superintendent finalists, and elect a Student Senate
Aug	Conversations on budget, mental health and student voice, including new Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed
Fall	LGBTQIA+ protections confirmed after federal Title IX changes; weighted grades policy work continues

02 · WHAT'S CHANGED

REAL RESULTS, SO FAR

31 students in the Act 95 group

9 Student Senators elected at West

38% of high schoolers surveyed interested in weighted grades

3 public progress reports

Already done

✓ Student Senate launched for 2026–27

✓ Students on the principal interview panel

✓ Students heard from superintendent finalists

Still open

Clearer messages to students after incidents, reporting explained in plain language, and a way for students to see what their input changed.

03 · WHERE WE'RE GOING

A DISTRICT STUDENT ADVISORY COUNCIL

Who: students from every middle and high school, PPA included

When: regular meetings with district leaders

What: climate, communication, and input before decisions

Built to last: a charter and staff partner that outlive any one leader

How input becomes action

1. Students raise an issue
2. The council gathers more input
3. A written recommendation goes in
4. The district answers in writing
5. **Everyone sees what changed**

STUDENT VOICE SHOULD MOVE BEYOND BEING HEARD TO BEING MEANINGFULLY CONNECTED TO ACTION.

MEETING HANDOUT · TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026 · SPWHS ROOM 1202

STUDENT VOICE & DISTRICT ENGAGEMENT

For Dr. Michael Morgan, Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion, and Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications. Prepared by Zackary Mark, Student Advocate, Sun Prairie West High School.

PURPOSE

Make student voice a regular, documented part of how SPASD listens and decides, so it lasts beyond any one student, principal or superintendent.

WORK SINCE JANUARY 2026

- Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board (Jan 13)
- Act 95 group of 31 students presented to the Board (Jan 26)
- Weighted grades work group with Dr. Curtis Mould (Feb to now)
- Advocacy meeting that helped launch the SPW Student Senate
- Students on the principal interview panel and superintendent finalist session
- Conversations with Dr. Reed, Dr. Turner, Ms. Thomas, Mr. Clark and Dr. Rodey
- Bilingual climate survey and three public progress reports

WHAT STUDENTS TOLD US

Safety & communication: after incidents, students often hear rumors first.

Consistency: follow-up feels different from building to building.

Follow-through: students feel heard symbolically, not systemically.

PROPOSAL: A DISTRICT STUDENT ADVISORY COUNCIL

Who: students from all three middle schools, East, West and PPA, across grades and backgrounds

When: regular meetings with district leadership, with agendas and minutes

What: school climate, communication, student experience, input before decisions

Built to last: a written charter, a staff partner, and public "you said, we did" updates

WHERE YOUR OFFICES FIT

Strategic Communications: student-facing messages, channels that reach students, and a home for public updates.

Systemic Equity & Inclusion: making sure every group has a way in, Spanish access, and climate and belonging across buildings.

QUESTIONS FOR TODAY

1. What does meaningful student voice look like to your offices?
2. Where could students give input before a decision, not after?
3. Who on staff could own an ongoing student group?
4. How should students hear back on what changed and why?

NEXT STEPS

Meeting handout

October 20 Meeting Notes (both meetings)

Both meetings on October 20 were audio recorded with permission. The raw auto-transcripts are not reproduced here: they are garbled in places and include other students' names. These notes come from Zackary's handwritten notes and the recordings. District staff statements are summarized, not quoted word for word.

Student Voice & District Engagement — 1:30–2:30 PM, Room 1202

Handwritten notes, typed up:

- Who: Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr., Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion; Marlita Bevenue, Director of Strategic Communications
- Where: Sun Prairie West High School, Room 1202
- Time: 1:30 p.m. → 2:30 p.m.
- Reminders: audio recording; handouts; survey; future meeting

Q1 (slide 7): after a serious incident, how is it decided what students are told, how fast, and by whom?

- What counts as a "serious incident"?
- Some incidents don't directly impact students
- Age, severity, etc. decide whom and when
- Leadership decides who sends it
- Can't share: confidential records
- HS = emails; certain info protected by law
- Employee protections

Comms team

- Works with leaders of individual schools
- Confirm facts, determine what students need to know
- Review/coordination — Ms. Bevenue
- No names

District newsletters

- Families, and students as part of the household
- Not intentional that students didn't get them
- Thinking about audience
- Not withholding info
- Comms looks at it through multiple lenses
- Info from students isn't verified
- Communicate with students directly

June 2027 question

- Survey students about what student voice should look like / sound like
- Then set goals

- Student/family newsletters — November
- About 8,500 students, 4K–12
- Benchmarks → goals
- Student body perspectives

From the recording:

- Dr. Morgan said his answers were his own understanding, not a formal district communication protocol. He gave the example of a student struck by a vehicle the week before at another school: students at West likely wouldn't get a message because it didn't directly affect them.
- Ms. Bevenue described the steps: safety first, then her office works with the principal and district leadership to confirm facts and decide what each audience needs to know. Messages come from the principal, district leadership or the superintendent depending on severity, and more information follows as it's confirmed. Names, individual consequences, student records and personnel matters can't be shared.
- Zackary said he'd never received a district newsletter in four years. Ms. Bevenue said newsletters launching in November with Dr. Reed will go to all students. Dr. Morgan called it a process improvement, not intentional.
- Zackary asked for short factual messages even without names, naming the specific law when something can't be shared, and "you said, we did" updates.
- On June 2027: Dr. Morgan said the first step is to survey students on what good student voice looks and sounds like, then set goals with benchmarks (a few changes by June 2027, more by fall 2027, and onward). Ms. Bevenue said students should be able to name something that changed because they spoke up, and hear back on every idea, even when the answer is no.
- Dr. Morgan's feedback: the survey should reach all three high schools, all four grade levels, and a racially and gender-diverse range of students.
- Time ran out before the advisory council and equity questions.

Weighted Grades Work Group — 10:00–10:40 AM (Google Meet)

From the recording:

- The 5.0 scale criteria from Oct 15 stand: capstone classes, tryout-based music courses, and classes earning industry certification or college credit, except college classes that match what the high school offers or don't transfer to UW schools.
- Example given: Calc 2 at Madison College would be weighted because it transfers to UW schools, even though the high school offers Calc BC. Start College Now and a Madison College PE class would not.
- Next step: counselors go through the full list of Madison College classes. Weighted classes will be marked in the course guide.
- Roll-in decision: students agreed it should start with next year's freshmen (Class of 2031) in 2027–28, because current students already chose classes under the old system. Zackary agreed. Ms. Wendorf confirmed Infinite Campus can handle it.
- Students raised concerns about clear language and communication when only freshmen have weighted grades. Dr. Mould said there's no way to make everyone happy, so clarity

and transparency matter most.

- Dr. Mould will put together a one-page "decision on a page" communication package for the group to review.
- Students on the SPW Student Senate will share it with the Senate the following Wednesday.
- Next: the student group previews the decision at the Teaching & Learning Committee on Monday, November 2 at 4:45 PM at the District Service Center (board members Melissa Grayson and Amanda Davis sit on it), then the Board meeting on November 9, with final approval expected at the end of November. Zackary said he works both of those days.
- Next work group meeting: the following Tuesday.

Student Advocacy Report #4 (October 2026)

Sent to Dr. Morgan and Ms. Bevenue as a draft on October 20 so they could flag anything inaccurate before it was published. On October 21, Ms. Bevenue replied that she had no additional feedback and confirmed in writing that district family newsletters will go to students starting in November.

From heard to "here's what changed"

What students learned from district leaders about incident communication, the first "you said, we did" commitment, and what student voice should look like by June 2027. Meeting with SPASD district leaders, Tuesday, October 20, 2026. Prepared by Zackary Mark, Student Advocate.

01 At a glance

Two SPASD directors met with student advocates and made one concrete commitment on the spot.

- Commitment: district newsletters launching in November will go to all students, not just families.
- Incident communication: what students hear depends on direct impact, age and severity. Some details can't be shared by law.
- Shared goal: by June 2027, students should be able to name something that changed because they spoke up.
- What's next: a wider, more representative survey on what good student voice looks and sounds like.

02 Who we met and why

- Dr. Michael D. Morgan Jr. — Director of Systemic Equity & Inclusion, SPASD
- Marlita Bevenue — Director of Strategic Communications, SPASD
- Zackary Mark — Student Advocate, SPASD Student Voice

The goal was to move student voice from being heard to being connected to action. We ran out of time before discussing a district student advisory council and equity questions, and plan to pick those up at a follow-up meeting.

03 How incident communication works today

Safety comes first, facts come second, and the message comes after that. Dr. Morgan noted his answers reflected his own understanding, not a formal written district protocol.

What decides whether students are told:

- Direct impact. An incident at one school is unlikely to be shared with students at a school it didn't affect.
- Age of students. Messages are shaped to be age-appropriate.
- Severity. More serious incidents get more communication and come from higher up.

The steps, as Ms. Bevenue described them:

1. Make sure everyone is safe and accounted for.
2. Communications works with the principal and district leadership to confirm facts.
3. Decide who is affected, what each audience needs, and what's ready to share.
4. Her team prepares and reviews the message.
5. It comes from the principal, district leadership, or the superintendent, based on severity.
6. More information follows as it's confirmed.

What can't be shared, and why:

- Names of students involved — student privacy laws; many involve minors
- Individual consequences and discipline — protected student records
- Grades and other student records — protected student records
- Personnel matters — employee protections; directors often don't have the details either

Both directors stressed accuracy. Rumors on social media can spread faster than the district can verify facts, and sending wrong information would hurt trust more than a short delay.

04 What students asked for

Hear something reliable from the district, even when details can't be shared, because silence gets filled by rumors.

- Short, factual messages: even with no names, "a medical incident closed this area, here's what you need to know" takes five minutes and stops rumors.
- Name the law: when something can't be shared because of a law, say which one. Many students will look it up.
- Trust students' understanding: students often feel information is held back because adults assume they won't get it. Most do.
- "You said, we did" updates: follow up on what actually happened, even if it's "nothing changed yet, here's what's happening."

Ms. Bevenue agreed students should hear directly from the district so they have a reliable source: clarify what's known, correct inaccurate information, and explain what's still being learned.

05 You said, we did: newsletters to all students

Starting in November, district newsletters will go to every student, not only to families.

- You said: in four years of high school, I had never received a district newsletter, and neither had many students I know.
- The district said: students were assumed to get family newsletters as part of the household. Dr. Morgan called it a process improvement, not intentional.
- The commitment: Ms. Bevenue will make sure newsletters go to all students when they launch in November with Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed.

This is exactly the kind of change student voice is supposed to produce. We'll report back once the first newsletter goes out.

06 What success looks like by June 2027

Students should be able to name something that changed because they spoke up, and the goals should come from students themselves.

- Ask students first: with about 8,500 students from 4K to 12th grade, Dr. Morgan said the first step is to survey students in age-appropriate ways on what student voice working well looks and sounds like. For the youngest learners, that may mean asking families.
- Set goals with benchmarks: not every idea can happen by June. A realistic plan might commit to a few changes by June 2027, a few more by fall 2027, and keep going into 2028.
- Close the loop: Ms. Bevenue said students should know where to bring an idea and hear back what happened, even if the answer is "we can't do that, and here's why." She encouraged students to be specific.
- What would show progress: a district-wide student survey, a district student advisory council with middle and high schoolers, and regular "you said, we did" updates.

07 Weighted grades update

The student work group agreed weighted grades should start with the Class of 2031 in 2027–28.

- Which classes: a 5.0 scale for capstone classes, tryout-based music courses, and classes earning industry certification or college credit.
- Exceptions: college classes that don't transfer to UW schools, or that match electives or requirements the high school already offers.
- Why freshmen: current students already chose classes under the old system, so switching now wouldn't be fair.

Timeline: week of Oct 26 — shared with the Student Senate · Nov 2, 4:45 PM — student preview, Teaching & Learning Committee · Nov 9 — Board of Education meeting · late November — expected final Board approval.

08 Next steps and what's still open

- Send district newsletters to all students — Ms. Bevenue — committed, November
- Expand the climate survey to all high schools, all grade levels, and a racially and gender-diverse range of students — Zackary Mark — in progress
- Draft questions on what good student voice looks and sounds like — Zackary Mark — in progress
- Share the survey through district channels — not yet named — open
- Name a staff partner for a pilot district student advisory council — not yet named — open
- Set a recurring student–district check-in — not yet named — open
- Publish one public "you said, we did" update this semester — not yet named — open

The survey changes come from Dr. Morgan's feedback that results should reflect diverse perspectives, not the same small group of involved students.

09 How we got here

Jan 13 — Student Safety & Trust Framework sent to the Board · Jan 26 — Act 95 students present at a public hearing · Feb — weighted grades work group begins · Mar 2 — student advocacy meeting with leaders · Apr — principal interviews; Student Senate elected · Aug — meetings with Dr. Reed, Dr. Turner, Mr. Clark · Oct 1 — LGBTQIA+ protections confirmed in writing · Oct 20 — first "you said, we did" commitment.

> "Yes I feel safe at school. Yes I would feel comfortable telling an adult. No adults do not listen." — a student, winter 2026 outreach. This is the gap this work exists to close.

About this report: an independent, student-led report, not an official publication of the Sun Prairie Area School District. It is based on notes and an audio recording from the October 20, 2026 meeting, recorded with permission, and the student weighted grades work group meeting that morning. District statements are summarized, not quoted word for word, and Dr. Morgan's answers reflect his own understanding rather than formal district policy. Both directors were offered a chance to flag inaccuracies before publication.